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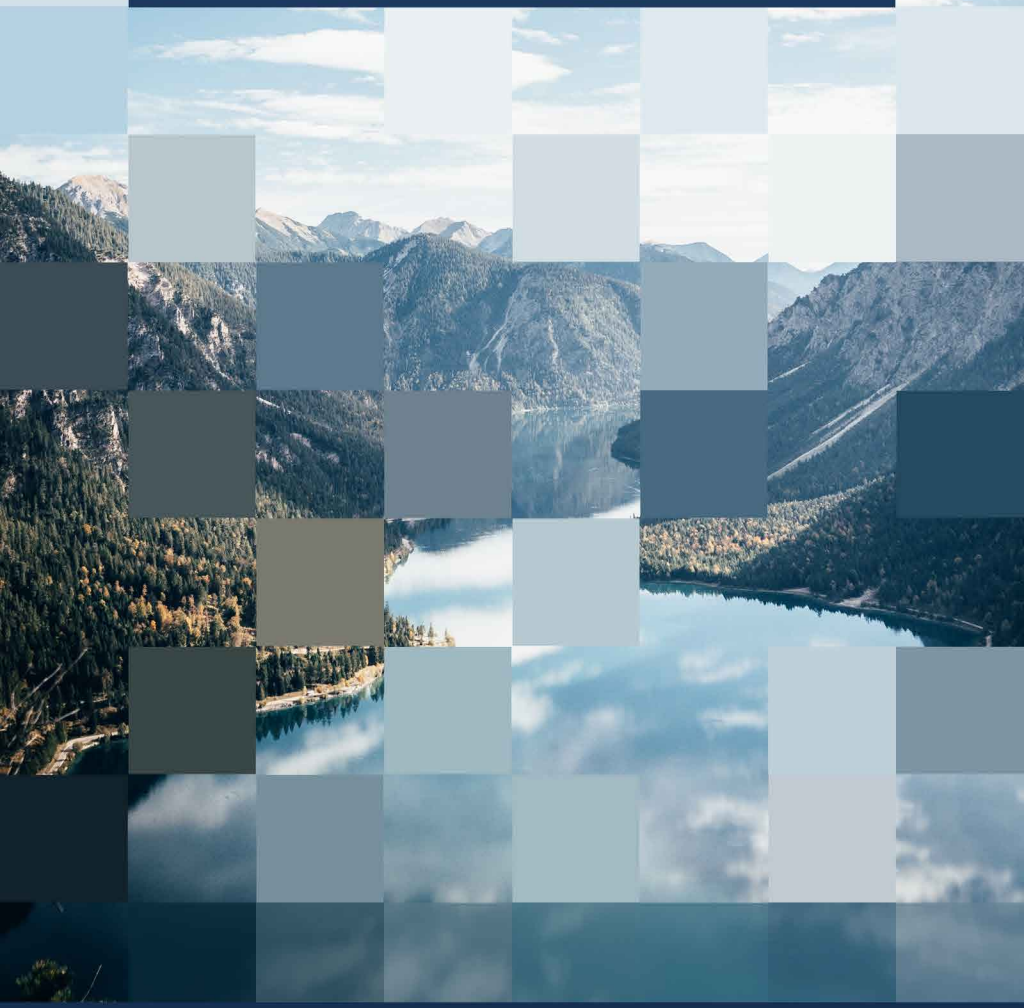
The Patchwork Manifesto

HOW TO CREATE YOUR REALITY IN A POST-2020 WORLD



Paul Publisher

ANCIENT STORIES
RADICAL NEW CONTEXTS

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Introduction

We are quickly moving into an era of radical freedom, where we will gradually become free of constraints that mankind has adopted since agrarian civilization began.

I'm speaking of basic, fundamental constraints like money, contractual relationships, work and even Time itself. These constraints will continue to exist in some form, but they will be so hybridized, so *ad hoc* that they will lose the consistency and authority we associate with them. In that sense, they won't be constraints but more like patches that we can combine in infinitely new ways.

The terror that this will inspire is equally matched by unparalleled opportunity. When the old structures and contexts are gone, so are the attendant rules. We will be free to live as men and women of our own making—and yet if we deign to be God, we will be harshly reminded of the chaos in which our freedom takes place.

Truly understanding the Old World that we are leaving behind is crucial for navigating this Brave New World. The millennia-old meta-codes once operating behind our society, but which became fully demolished in 2020, were essentially stories narrating *how to organize an agrarian society*.

"But we had already shifted out of an agrarian model, well before 2020," you say. "We moved through the Industrial Age, and from there into a post-industrial model."

From a metaphysical perspective, however, Western society never left the agrarian model. Essential agrarian codes became embedded in modern institutions. The start of the school year became tied to the harvest season, for example. This is also around Labor Day, when we shake off the leisure vibes and knuckle down again; in the past, we've often seen stock market highs or "harvests" at this time.

But the biggest place you would see these agrarian codes show up is in male-female intersexual relations—perhaps the most important building block for our society.

We know men and women have completely different mating strategies and thus different psycho-social development within the human family. In a forthcoming manifesto I will attempt to show how cultural narratives dramatized that psycho-social feature, and then also show how world-historical events are breaking down these once-stable relations between sexes, leading to the mass social change we see before us.

As a result, we are moving into a multi-temporal era, where various tribes will be subscribing to myriad timelines, because they each have a different teleological endgame in mind.

There is no longer an overarching macro narrative that holds communities together across geographic and generational lines, via the enforcement of such codes. Today, an average family man is sometimes seen to be as radical as punk rock.

To me, the Fertile Crescent agrarians hammered out a stable societal narrative in its most useful form, when they began developing the astrological Zodiac. They viewed the individual as a distinct, sovereign being with a unique soul. And yet, this individual was always understood within the wider context of the collective human family. His story was narrated by cosmic or divine forces, and the story was always about fashioning a microcosm of that collective family through a local biological network.

Heuristics aside, I believe we should continue our investigation from this cosmic framework, because these civilizations were our forefathers. Despite flashy smartphones and whatnot, the meta-codes of our society up until this moment predominantly reflect those meta-codes established by ancient Babylonia and adjacent regions.

Furthermore, since these meta-codes intended to model a stable socio-sexual paradigm within the homeland, they were also, by extension, focused on maintaining cross-regional stabilization. The last thing you want is for your family unit to be constantly on edge.

Essentially, the human family—the backdrop against which the individual develops—is no longer supported by a cohesive integrated society and set of reliable meta-stories, as put forth by a trustworthy executive class (typically a small circle of male elders).

As world-historical events allowed corruption to seep into these circles, so too was society destabilized behind the scenes—and now that has been exposed. A corrupt executive class sought to bring our peaceful interconnected society to a kind of perverse apotheosis, in the form of a simulated global village or a modern Tower of Babel to rule over us—a synchronized matrix of 24/7 information deliveries.

But this modern Tower of Babel has fallen and the "supply chains of meaning" that it coordinated have also been disrupted. As a result, our "normal" social codes are in a state of utter desynchronization. In the absence of masters giving believable orders, many don't know how to live. Others are high on the newfound freedom.

Exposed corruption has allowed the narratives around us to quite rapidly fragment and shatter. Dependable societal contexts have been displaced by a reckoning moment.

Even though the reckoning moment has occurred lightning-quick, the corruption has gradually infiltrated our executive class across successive eras, distorting our overarching

societal context to the point that millennia-old hierarchical principles can no longer express themselves properly and produce family-first narratives for the human collective.

Patchwork Consciousness represents the new stories we can tell ourselves. We can combine bits of the enduring tatters in ways that put families and free will first, while dependence on large overarching institutions comes second, if at all.

But that doesn't mean society as a whole can "return to tradition"; this will only occur in patches or pockets. As I'm emphasizing, all types of macro contexts are gone—completely and permanently displaced—and can't be reinstated.

We only have patchy scraps of the monuments that arose out of such stable contexts—both ideational and material monuments—built according to the hierarchical principles encoded in our DNA.

The new context is characterized by keywords like temporary, local, decentralized, tribal, perma-fluid and fragmentary.

The unthinkable has happened—we have lost a social context considered Eternal—and now what we have is a messy creative ferment promising great freedom, experimentation and changeability. At the same time, the hierarchical principles encoded in our DNA will have great difficulty expressing themselves in this environment, where symmetry and clear communication is elusive.

Thus, we will all have great difficulty communicating with each other and even with ourselves, as all meaning and narratology takes place at constantly-fragmenting local levels, in both physical and psycho-spiritual senses.

Those who can be nimble "translators" and mercenary go-betweens will be highly prized. Asymmetry is on its way, and growing awareness of this will produce new calls for apolitical "unity." Such unity will never fully arrive, but people will seek to acknowledge that a dominant Macro Narrative has been replaced by a creative ferment of various endgames. These endgames don't have to be antagonistic to each other, but tribalism may portray them as a threat.

Our future state of affairs could easily devolve into a chaotic situation, again much like after the Tower of Babel fell, opening us up to great risk for tribal violence. This is how the desire for hierarchy can express itself in distorted form. The natural human impulse to coordinate meta-codes in a vertical fashion will no longer find traction in such a decentralized, horizontal landscape. Those who attempt to build up will strike out.

In fact, tribal violence will only lead to more of what it seeks to escape, as tit-for-tat creates splinters even within warring groups, due to some members deciding they want peace or, alternatively, a more “ideologically pure” form of the Holy Cause.

There will be a massive resurgence of cults, which naturally revolve around charismatic leaders/prophets but sometimes are just high on a "cause.” Also, since the Patchwork Age can fractionate us down to the solo level, you’ll see a return to saint-like experiences: extreme visions, encounters with angels, demons and even God.

Aesthetically, the movements that arise out of this chopped-up reality will not form a centralized Hive but exist more within an observable "frequency" that connects various nodes. “Being on a similar wavelength” will matter greatly, and that will organically arise from the micro-narratives. Artists might lead the way, as meaning and authenticity and vision become the age’s preeminent resources. Severe backlash is in store for prefabricated, centralized, commodified versions of togetherness.

More than anything, Patchwork Consciousness wants to maximize connective potential and ripple effects in the collective network, so every spat in essence ironically serves the purpose of combinatory growth. In the Patchwork Age, every node is also a vector, which is why it’s futile to think of yourself as a unit who can simply be grouped in tribes based on external signifiers like political affiliation.

A do-it-yourself ethos will ripple across the land, as individuals learn to manage their own supply chains of meaning. People will be stitching together their days. Each decision made in how to spend or value one’s time becomes a creative act. The passivity of the Consumerist Age is—poof—no longer dominant.

Our experience of Time will be utterly altered by this creative act, because fragments of various traditions will suddenly meet each other via new patched-together visions.

Of course, this larger context might only make sense to us and our tribe, much unlike recent decades, when citizens all had the same water cooler conversations about politicians and pensions and pastimes.

This is what healing is ultimately about when you’re sitting in the ruins of Western Civilization: accepting that your heart might be the only proof of your vision’s validity. You must lead by example. You must live your values, even when others push back. Embrace the chaos.

At any rate, back to our foundational pattern. The traditional agrarian narrative is a story that begins at birth within the homeland (usually a farmstead); it develops through childhood, then

onto puberty; in teenhood there is brief outside travel and sexual initiations, followed by adulthood, marriage, children, family estate building, community building and death. It is a stacked, logical, progressive developmental story.

All individuals come into this life at a different stage of development, with different strengths, weaknesses, challenges and opportunities. But, traditionally, each person always exists within this overarching context of the collective human family, covertly governed by myths and narratives generated by an arcane executive class that engages diplomatically with similar roundtables from other regions.

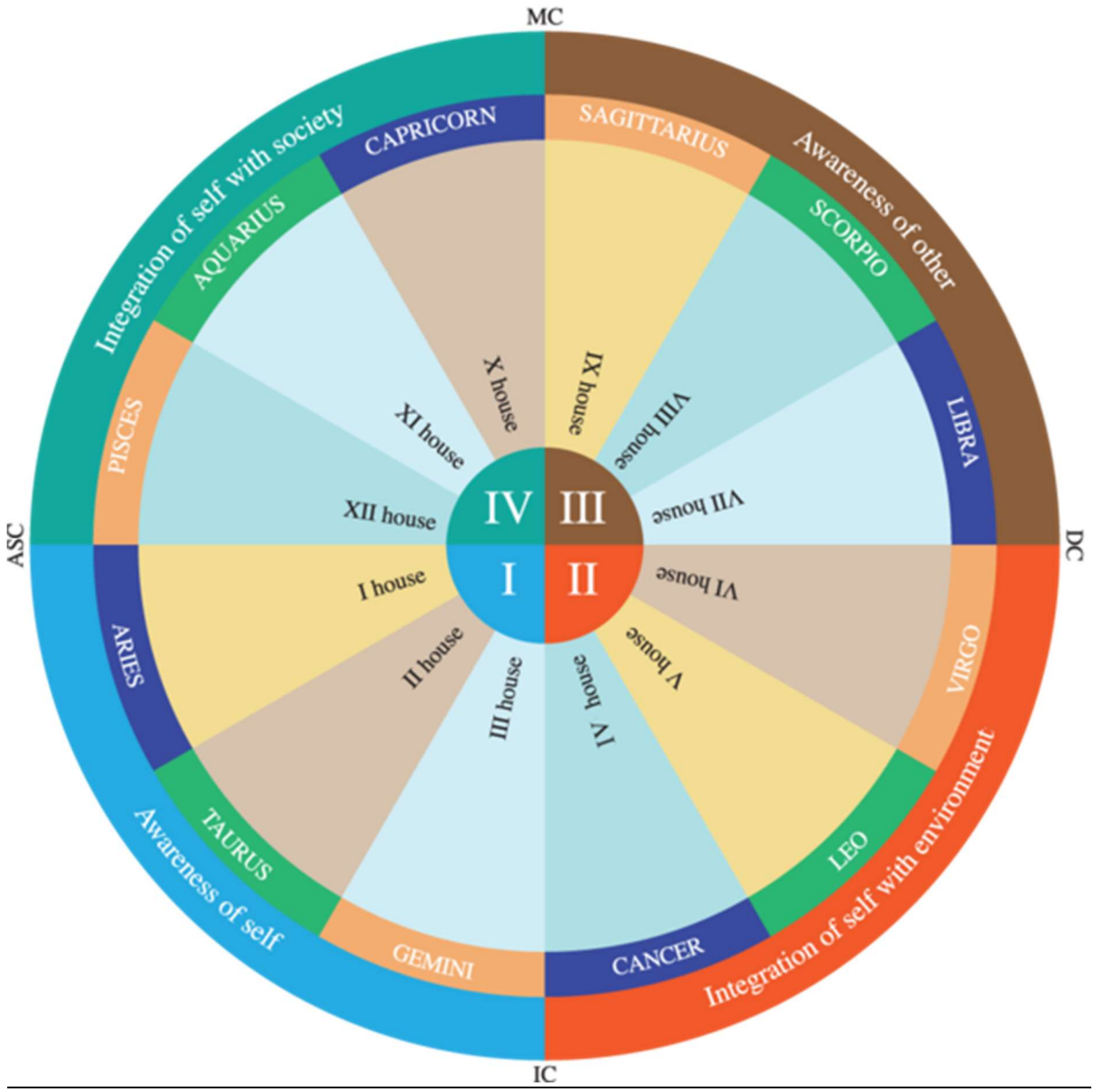
Everyone has a unique destiny and role. Some are humble servicemen. Some are rock stars. This destiny unfolds in Time. The prospect of war with a neighboring region was only considered when the cross-regional meta-codes, already coordinated, had been trespassed upon.

We have maximized those fundamental agrarian meta-codes like money, work and time in order to create a complex, interconnected global village that goes way beyond cross-regional cooperation into a totalized matrix. This is fundamentally a perversion of cosmic balance and growth, aided and abetted by greed and dominance.

The reckoning that arrived—and delivered its final blow in 2020—shattered this Tower, such that we cannot even go back to the sane foundation it sought to usurp. Karmic bills came due, ensuring we never do this again.

Over the next 20 years, the way forward is to pick up enduring bits of rubble and combine them in radical ways. Old knowledge, new context.

A breakthrough via breakdown is coming.



Part One: The Human Story

…Or: *Examples of collective stories at work to portray the psycho-social development of individuals within the human family.*

In the pre-modern world, man's average life span was 36. Thus, elders set to work narrating each stage of man's life through collective stories, prescriptive myths, customs, rituals and social norms.

Taking age 36 as an end point, they divided up man's growth into groups of three years, creating a model of 12 distinct growth stages. They used divine sources like the astrological Zodiac to detail each 3-year chapter in this progressive psycho-social narrative.

The overall purpose of putting certain rituals and stories in front of individuals at a relevant age was to orient their consciousness within a stable society and give them (as well as their parents, grandparents and children) some continuity of experience.

There is a high degree of refinement in this psycho-social narrative. Each psychological stage or chapter—dramatized in ritual, custom, story, etc.—is analogous to a very real non-fiction environment or operation in the society at large.

For example, the universal psychological pang felt by a Western individual as he nears 30 is dramatized in stories such as *Hamlet*, where a late-20s man questions whether his personal responsibility matters at all in the grand scheme.

And this quintessential late 20s psychological storyline reflects a very real sociological feature: it speaks of and dramatizes an executive management class that imposes law and limitation to enforce personal responsibility.

In other words, it's essential for growing adults to really understand what this rite of passage into age 30 is all about, but rather than speak of a heady, abstract executive class in explicit terms, we have the digestible myth of Hamlet instead.

From a bird's eye view, what's uncanny is that this divine 36-year narrative is reflected in scientific findings. For example, even modern stories intended for 7 to 9-year-olds often revolve around making new connections in one's local environment—such as accommodating new neighbors or constructing *ad hoc* tools—which is reflective of increasing myelination (i.e. new neural connections) happening in one's brain during that age bracket. Furthermore, these modern stories often have deep roots in ethnic myth or fairy tales.

The US Constitution, too, shows that this 36-year cycle represents some kind of threshold into death or destiny: it doesn't allow anyone younger than 35 to become President. We still consider this age—when one would've typically died—as a time when you really face karma. Since we have longer lifespans today, 36 is typically considered the beginning of the "mid-life" crisis stage, when one attempts to become "reborn."

In this paradigm of 36 years we also see the importance of the halfway point, age 18, which was commemorated with major rituals and rites of passage in agrarian times. As a halfway point in man's mortal circle, it represented an important moment with respect to fertility, sexuality and the birthing of a new generation. Even in our current society, we consider this a time of leaving home, going to college, losing one's virginity and finding one's non-blood related tribe.

Continuing with this thread, a man in his mid-50s—who is yet another 18 years older than the mid-30s men who are "dying"—would by traditional standards be considered a miracle of health and endurance. For that reason, these elder statesmen, retired from all service, would constitute the bulk of the small, exclusive executive class roundtable we just spoke of.

Later on, we'll talk more about this triple-decker generational set of affairs, where 18-year-olds represent the budding vision, where the "crisis stage" late 30-somethings represent active destiny and where the elders represent wise management.

As you might already be aware of, current society is somewhat obsessed with cultivating these generations into distinct and sometimes antagonistic movements (think: "teenage culture") whereas they're originally intended to be interconnected and hierarchically supportive of each other.

But let's start with the psycho-social map of individuals as they grow within the human family, as outlined by our agrarian forebearers and as elaborated upon in modern stories.

There is an important purpose for this section: to understand the radical, desynchronized, non-linear environment we are about to enter, we must understand the age-old narrative that is breaking apart and giving way to a Brave New World.

To see where we are going, we must understand the society we are coming from.

The Aries Years

An infant or toddler represents the budding next generation and so it is considered the collective's most prized unit—with the exception of, perhaps, a young fertile woman. Everything within this first chapter is charged with the need for survival. An individual is fighting for their life against sickness, predators and the natural elements.

In other words, these early years are when an infant is incredibly vulnerable. The infant's primary and most efficacious channel is the cry or the scream, to alert the tribe that they are hungry, sick or in danger.

Even in relatively safe environments, tantrums are about as sophisticated as an infant can get. The "terrible twos," as two-year-old kids are known.

There's not much balance or nuance at this stage. The energetic volume is always at a fever pitch. One must strike first, selfishly and often, because otherwise the risk is death, abandonment or hunger. In this stage, we know ourselves mostly through pressing needs. It does, however, herald a later stage of development, when bold words must be spoken with courage.

Baby Moses is a popular story relating to this stage of development. Found crying in the bulrushes by a pharaoh's daughter, he later delivered the Ten Commandments—some of the most enduring meta-codes of our civilization.

The Taurus Years

As childhood arrives after the toddler years, survival has been accomplished. Now values must be projected. There is an intense stubbornness, a digging in of heels, a standing of one's ground.

In these early childhood years, a child is developing distinct likes and dislikes. There's not much sense of delayed gratification: what the newly emerging "I" wants, it gets. Children at this age understand that action can result in praise or blame, so they're developing a sense of self-worth and what they bring to the table. Ethnic identity occupies a place in consciousness.

Despite the entrance of relatively subtler emotions, we're still in a rudimentary zone. If a child experiences displeasure, they may extract themselves from an interaction and go sit alone like a bull in a field, securing their own value. There's lots of sticking fingers in ears and saying, "I can't heeeeaaarrrr you!"

Pinocchio would be a prime meta-code enshrouding this age, as it deals with the development of inner values ("I want to be a *real* boy"), the experience of primitive agency ("Pleasure Island") and the awareness of consequences (a growing nose).

The Gemini Years

During the early elementary years, myelination in the brain—which builds connectivity between neurons—is moving from frontal regions into the back brain. This increase in white matter results in improved spatial awareness and use of language. The senses are geared towards understanding positionality and relationality between distinct objects.

At this stage, the individual is dealing with immediate psycho-physiological limitations. Improved motor coordination and speech allows for a newfound mobility, but alas, not invincibility.

Grey matter in the frontal cortex is also increasing, boosting short-term memory and problem-solving ability.

The meta-codes narrating this stage of development thus reflect the growing complexity of the child's nervous system. The narrative environment is primarily locomotive in expression, but kept to the confines of the town or neighborhood. There are no broad generalizations: instead, social and ideational connection facilitates the exploration of detail and nuance.

Suddenly, as the child moves further from cave of survival, he sees the world getting just a little bit bigger. He tastes a hint of the larger collective encircling him. Cousins, neighbors and siblings occupy supporting roles.

The books written by Beatrix Potter during the Victorian Age were deeply influenced by ancient meta-codes narrating this developmental stage (early tweens). She drew on the Old Testament, Aesop's Fables, European fairy tales, Scottish myth, German Romanticism and Shakespeare, among other sources.

The early tween psycho-social profile is dramatized well in Potter's Peter Rabbit books, which are about a rag-tag group exploring their local farmstead and engaging with familiar neighbors, as well as having to develop resourcefulness in the face of environmental obstacles, like the arrival of a new neighbor.

The Cancer Years

At the later tween stage, the child is considered old enough to supervise younger siblings. They begin to understand the element of care and love within relationships. Nurturance and defense are keywords.

Here, the child's amygdala retains prominence. The amygdala keeps us in a state of being alert to environmental dangers, so that we can protect ourselves and our family. It helps us tap into our "gut awareness" and gauge the trustworthiness of an outside party. Thus, impulsivity is still present because the individual is learning to manage the emotion of fear.

Mood swings are common, especially within situations involving the biological family, which has come to dominate awareness again as the individual's consciousness is focused more on values of safety, security, home, nurturance and care.

At home, these mood swings may frequently take place around the dinner table, where the family congregates. The individual is greatly aware of their body image at this stage, and food plays a part in this. They have a sense of accomplishment from greater physical strength and adult-like proportions. The self is defined through familial identity.

Middle childhood (or the late tween stage) marks the development of intuitive abstract thinking. In times of stress and amygdala overload, however, the child will revert to concrete thought. Self-consciousness is another keyword here.

The world must come to us now, not vice-versa, so there's an assimilative effect, much like a crab that picks apart a food source with its claws, feeding bits to itself. We pull everything back to this inner emotional world, this psychological point of origin, in order to remain intact as we attempt to navigate an increasingly complex world.

A striking contemporary example of the traditional meta-narrative intended for this age is the movie *E.T.* The protagonist, 10-year-old Elliott, cobbles together a transceiver from a coffee can and electronic keyboard in his immediate environment, reflecting the increased brain myelination achieved in the previous developmental stage.

The movie is all about a new "alien" neighbor who arrives in Elliott's backyard, helping him get a new look at his familiar SoCal suburban neighborhood. But the crucial narrative focus here is on the development of empathy within Elliott, which is presented as his primary avenue of communication with the alien and his 5-year-old sister, who he must supervise.

This deep emotional connection with a state of care is dramatized when Elliott feels intoxicated at school while the alien drinks beer back at his suburban home.

There are other preoccupations with food, nurturance and home throughout: indeed, the movie begins with Elliott luring the alien via candy. The movie is considered a retelling of older fairy tales, like Peter Pan (Elliott reads the book to his sister in one scene) and The Frog King, an old German story which itself has roots in frog tales going back to the 13th-century and possibly before.

The Leo Years

Ah, and then the early teen years arrive. "You're not the boss of me!"

By now, the individual's consciousness is developing away from the family table. With security achieved, they're ready to roar their unique voice, leap out from the biological matrix and encounter the outer world again.

Egoic strength is required to make this leap. Individuals at this stage are acutely aware of rejection. They must connect with what's unique in them, so that they can authentically connect with what's unique in others.

In essence, the inward focus of middle childhood now shifts toward teenage outward expression. Our ego is taking center stage. Instead of being mired in a recursive internal emotional matrix, our barbell is the present tense balanced with an awareness of future possibilities. At this stage of development, an individual is able to generate hypothetical outcomes.

Likewise, the social circle is expanding beyond blood relations while simultaneously offering up a select few "best friends." Importantly, these friendships extend across gender lines and the individual experiences dating, romance, puppy love and in general the "amorous spark."

What's happening concurrently with this explosion of social and psychological development is a collective urge to *celebrate* an individual's newfound egoic solidification. The individual is now brave enough to navigate on their own a large non-bloodline social network, a.k.a. the general community of the town.

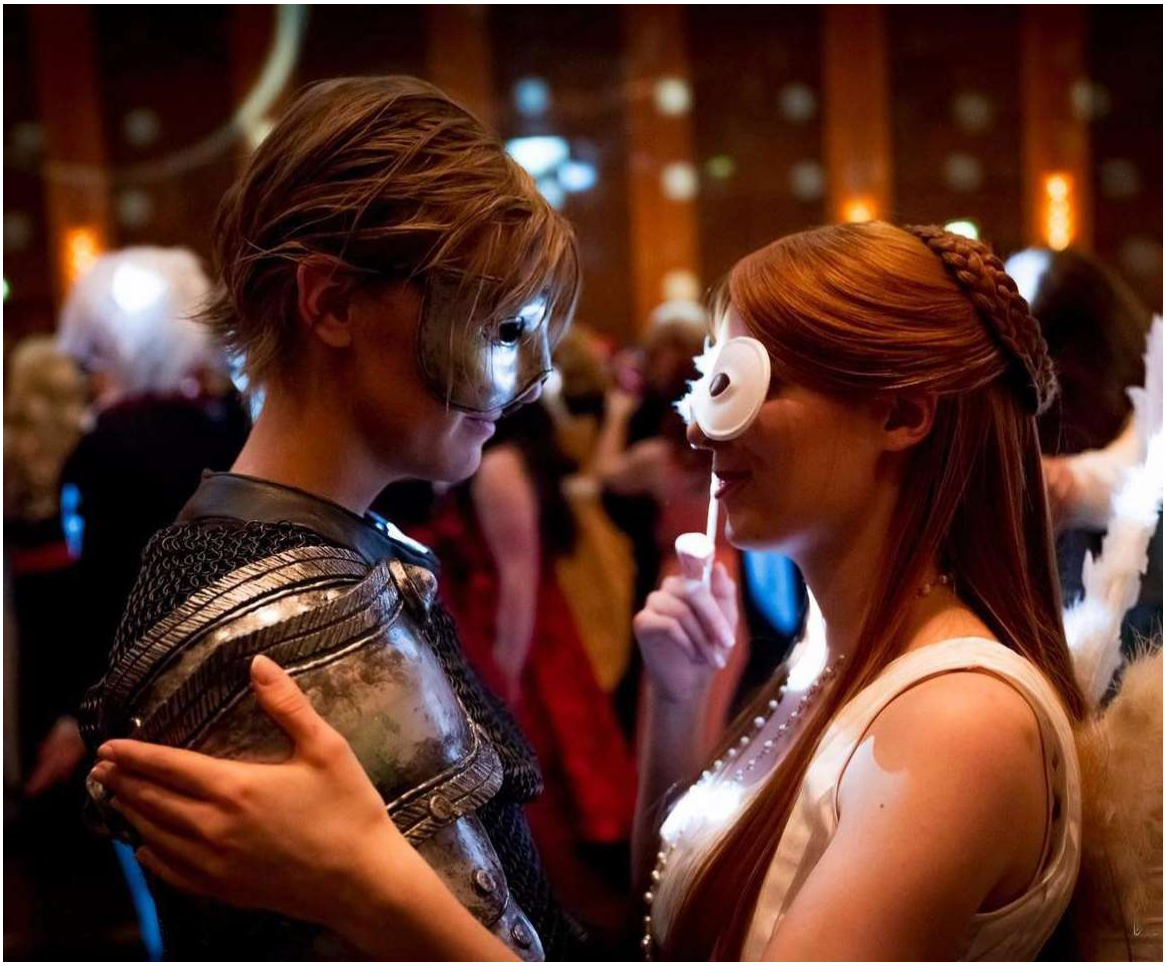
Thus, the individual birthday—"your special day"—takes on especial prominence now. In Hispanic communities, there's the Quinceanera celebration. Catholic communities give 13 or14-year-olds a Sacrament of Confirmation, while Jewish individuals of that age have sex-specific *mitzvah* parties.

Such parties frequently feature games of chance—think: pin the tail on the donkey—which encourage the sensation of touch between sexes and thereby reenact/enshrine the spark of "first love." Playful risk also inherently celebrates the teen's ability to generate hypotheses and ideas of what they'd like to grow up as—or, on a more amorous level, who they'd like to "go steady with."

The adults managing these festivities use such games to get back in touch with their inner adolescent and thus commemorate the passage of time. There may even be more risqué "adult" games or imbibing off to the side, away from adolescent eyes.

You might say that, despite the teenage neo-tantrums, this environment marks the first real production of multi-generational meaning, since both camps are operating from a position of (relative) free will.

Mark Twain's stories about Huck Finn and Tom Sawyer represent the quintessence of this psycho-social stage. Of course, we can't forget Becky Thatcher, the schoolmate who Tom falls in puppy love with.



The Virgo Years

During the later teen years, everything is in a state of adjustment. Voices are deepening and breaking. The skin is oiler, causing breakouts. Joints ache.

This constant adjustment is reflected in the fact that *labor* is now the preeminent site of action. Because the individual's cognitive abilities and physical proportions have matured, they are able to join the adults in higher-level labor responsibilities.

These advanced work duties were centered around grain harvesting—remember, even if the tales mentioned here have modern costuming, they derive from agrarian settings.

Though the sexes may be segregated into divisions of labor—men learning how to separate wheat from chaff, women learning how to refine and store flour—the common theme of field work is discernment. Their supervisors are not biological parents but other adults within the community, who use the time together to have a "birds and bees talk."

This "talk" is also a spiritual alignment ritual. The late teen's psychology is extremely attuned to an inner monologue. It's a mixture of thought, feeling, impression—all chattering away.

This chatterbox eternally returns—it's what Alan Watts calls the "nit nit nit" of persistent thought, and what Nietzsche calls the "again-biting of inner wit."

Such habitual patterning is where our "conscience" derives from. We talked about how toddlers develop a cause-and-effect sense, where the binary of praise/blame comes into play. But the Virgo stage is really where our "conscience" gets traction. The late teen uses inner tension and iteration to readjust disorderly environments, including their own morphing body. It is a time in life when we are trying to coordinate our personal schedule, skills, diet and exercise routines, but still need the guidance of a trusted supervisor.

If the supervisor isn't ideal, they try to make the teen's scattered attention more "efficient" by chaining them to pointless procedures, like chores without a fruit of labor. But a good mentor aims that daily grind at a loftier goal. Thus, this psychological stage is analogous to the coaches and service class members we find in society—people who help us move the needle an inch a day, who squeeze a flow out of their myopic attention to *process*. These may come in the form of teachers, personal trainers, line cooks or nurses.

The apotheosis of this psychological stage is a meticulous, constant and *committed* orientation to the world. "Improve, improve, improve a tiny bit with each life chapter," the individual now says to himself.

Ultimately, this patient progress will destroy itself with neuroticism unless it humbles itself before the goal of virginal purity and devotion.

Ancient narratives and occult systems are rife with the imagery of a virgin servant girl holding a sheaf of harvested wheat close to her body—a metaphorical hymen or inward psychological folding. The servant girl's attention to purity first separated the wheat stalks into individual "life chapters" and then she bundled them into a book-like collection. These chapters commemorate her seasons of service to Source.

She identifies with the result of her work. Not at all a loose tavern whore, she is bundled tightly by fastidious virtue—completely intact, pure and preserved.

Which brings us to an important question: do men and women experience this psychological stage differently, especially given the biological double standard around virginity and virility?

Absolutely, yes.

For women, the rituals surrounding this stage serve a (self)-protective function. Women go through certain rites to experience an *enfolding* energy. They sort through emotions, seeking purity of feeling rather than volatile hysterics.

Men, with their testosterone, are connected to rites of *unfolding*. They sort through external facts, seeking purity of truthful effort. This devotional labor can make them unable to relax, just as emotional chasteness in the extreme can lead to female nagging.

As recent as a couple generations ago, the average person's craft would've been agriculture. But the primal impulse of this stage remains: whether we're sorting grains or software code, here we learn to separate substance from waste.

To preserve the fruits of our ancestors, we must devote our conscience to a bigger picture. We come to see that our *entire life* is but one chapter—one turning of the season—in the great generational book of our ancestry.

Ah yes, you may have noticed that publishing season and the school year begins…in harvest season. Hmm. Is there something deeper going on? Is this connected to the "harvest season" of late teen psychology?

David Lynch's *Blue Velvet* portrays a young man returning home from school, immersed in awareness of his blossoming sexuality and drawn to the purity of a local high school senior.

What gives? Why is this narrative of adolescent sexual awakening so embedded in Western (Agri)-Culture?

First let's reaffirm that the late teen's psychological state of "efficiency" is analogous to the social environment of grain harvesting—and this harvest time plugs right into the September start of school, when the Sun traverses the astrological sign of Virgo the wheat field Virgin.

Meetings need to be penciled in, lunches need to be packed, sports practice needs to be accounted for, transportation organized and so on. Like a hormone-fueled teen mind, these social environments break down a complex system into discrete parts that can be re-tooled, shifted around, polished and buffed. Everything is a *mutable* and *transitional*, much like the harvest season itself.

But that still doesn't fully answer the question. Why do we put young men and women together as the days begin to shorten?

Consider how less daylight means less visibility. We must squint and peer now: truth is not so immediately apparent like a bright berry under the July Sun. Life chapters are passing us by. In the grand scheme, we are running out of time.

There's an awareness of winter (death) approaching. There's a great need to act with circumspection, because you can't pluck random fruit in winter, unlike your tropical brothers. Wheat must be separated from chaff: life depends on it. Peer harder. Find the kernel of truth. Find substance.

Thus, it is always this time of year when we send our sons away, to fulfill a *rite of passage*. There is something deeply shamanic about this rite. We initiate our sons into the awareness of mortality. Of course, today we're in the habit of sending our sons to work in fields of knowledge, like college, rather than wheat fields one town over.

Despite co-ed campuses now, I think this aspect of traveling to work or school was originally designed to be a shamanic male-only endeavor. In both cases, elders would use this time to discuss higher truths embedded in the mundane world. As the young men crack open the grains (or books) to find the vital endosperm, they do so with a reverence for the pure truth contained inside. The elders have prepared the young men for the next stage of life: taking a woman's virginity. (Indeed, Daoist literature on tantric sex refers to outer female genitalia as "the wheat berry.")

Women would stay at home to organize the domestic inventory and refine the accrued endosperm into a white flour that has shelf life. Chatting during these rote tasks, they would learn virginal virtue from the matriarchs. Modesty isn't just about physical abstinence: it literally means "to not assume you know all the details."

While men are skeptical about outer phenomena, women are encouraged to be skeptical about their fickle emotions. "I'm with a guy who's near-perfect but Jim Co-worker *seems* like a catch, too. *Sigh*." Modesty prevents her from getting into these mental traps.

But back to the original point: traveling to another town for work, especially alone, would have been unthinkable for a young woman. Promiscuity (or worse, rape) could fatally compromise her purity and marriageability, by removing her hymen and/or emotional equilibrium. A masterful story about this risk is presented in *Tess d'Urbervilles* by Thomas Hardy.

Sex thus "properly" occurs when the initiated young men return with their "bounty" and co-mingle with women in the home town. This is the occult meaning behind harvest festivals. You can find variations all over history, from the Grecian festival of Thesmophoria to the Polish festival of Dożynki to the Japanese festival of Utagaki.

Harvest time is when life defies the waning light. A crop of young men and women have reached maturation stage, like the wheat. Now they are fertile enough in body and mind to produce and nurture a new generational crop.

A bountiful harvest of seeds and flour rebukes death. The joy implies there's even enough to feed future mouths—so go on, get busy making firstborn babies.

The festive atmosphere of early fall traces back to ritualized gender separation and then re-bundling. During harvest season, men learn how to *penetrate* and *sacredly de-flower* life mysteries while women are busy learning how to refine and protect the purity of emotions. Afterwards they meet up and act out their "education."

Both genders are pursuing purity in ways they're designed to, which are complimentary but also diametrically opposed. Hence the biological double standard around virginity. The man tries to swoop—and the woman dodges. Both are going through their own adolescent "coming-of-age chapter." They are bridging pre-pubescence and adulthood. This is why age 18 seems somewhat arbitrary in modern times, when determining sexual consent: but in the context of a 36-year cycle, it is a bridge year.

Our modern world augments this harvest/fertility ritual of congregating in the face of coming winter. With our love for streamlined efficiency and assembly line virtue, every September we put men and women in the same wheat field from the get-go (university). The original sex ed ritual is condensed and abbreviated. A little historical note: the first American coed college opened in 1855, a tuition-free luxury made possible no doubt by Industrial Age time-savers like wheat threshing machines.

Who knows, post-pandemic homeschooling may restore the monogamist agricultural paradigm. Until then, modern society—which promotes co-ed college as a rite of passage—is essentially a hookup society. I make no value judgment here: that's just the way it is.

The origins of the harvest ritual may even go back to the Garden of Eden. "Being fruitful and multiplying" in Eden was just a matter of the masculine and the feminine agreeing to will life into being. Indeed, when Adam and Eve realize they are living immodestly ("naked" or without conscience) what happens is that they "fall" from being higher-dimensional spiritual beings into mortal 3-D.

To punish Adam's lack of skepticism about Eve's claim, God condemns man to "work by the sweat of his brow" and to "till the land from whence he came." This means agriculture literally but more loosely refers to masculinity toiling to find truth. No more free lunches, guys: yes, your mission is to sacredly de-flower now…but you are responsible for feeding the growing tribe.

Eve, on the other hand, did not practice discrimination around her emotions. She traveled to a far-off place without a chaperone, leaving herself open to serpentine fantasies that defiled her emotional virginity. Instead of practicing modesty, she indulged her vanity. Thus, God condemns women to vaginal childbirth. No more free lunches, women: yes, you get to bond in penetrative sex now…but you are responsible for managing the pregnancy.

In our post-Edenic world, it's *labor* for everyone, all around.

This is also why birth control is so controversial, because it's a free lunch subverting the labor principle behind sexual awakening.

Catcher in the Rye is a modern narrative of this developmental stage (note the central metaphor of a grain field). But you could also consider Luke Skywalker and Princess Leia in *A New Hope*. The whole coming-of-age genre and the "campus novel" is built around this crucial developmental stage. What happens here has major implications, at least from a traditional point of view: a new generation is entering adulthood and prime child-rearing years.

The Libra Years

In their early 20s, the individual is getting married, right on the heels of the harvest rituals just described. He is still firmly in the process of encountering destiny and his first real tribe—one that is truly of his own choosing.

As a result of this introduction into adulthood, the individual now has a greater responsibility to serve the surrounding polity. Thus, his relations are built on state-mediated contracts: marriage contracts, employment contracts, business licenses, etc.

The purpose of these contracts is to ensure fairness between both parties, specifically the individual and the state. Bureaucratic intermediaries pop up, to authenticate forms or processes.

The value of commitment and fidelity, in all arenas, comes to the fore. The individual is thinking long term: who do I work with best, given my value set, and what can I offer them? Skills developed during the previous stage become the foundation for occupation or vocation.

There is an idealism that grows alongside increased ability to think abstractly, shift variables around and test fairness. Perspective and point of view are keywords here, as are fairness, negotiation and justice.

During the previous stage, the front part of the brain—responsible for complex reasoning—initiated a last phase of major growth. During the present stage, we are blossoming into this front brain growth. The individual sees themselves as fully distinct from their biological family now, and yet is able to renegotiate relationships with parents, as they become parents in their own right. Maintaining connection, while remaining independent, is important.

All in all, we are moving away from the constant adjustments of the late teen years, towards a state of balance in all affairs. This stage allows for the building of one's own distinct family and tribe, certified by a body politic.

The character of Jane Bennett in *Pride and Prejudice* would be considered an avatar of this developmental stage.

The Scorpio Years

As the individual progresses into his mid-20s, things get a bit heavy. The individual has mouths to feed and committed relationships to maintain. Should any of these relationships need to be broken off, a lengthy and exhausting institutional process comes into play. The collective cannot risk breakoffs at whim. Cohesion must be disrupted only when necessary.

Even in good times, there's an element of ego transcendence to this developmental stage. We are dealing with pools of material and emotional/astral resources that extend way beyond the individual's present state. Grandparents are entering twilight years or even dying: the individual might be visited by their ghost, perhaps, and not just in the form of an inheritance. At the same time, generational continuity is ensured by the survival of children born during the previous stage.

Thus, estate management occurs now. Inheritances and wills need to be managed, due to the passing of ancestors. The young individual himself may draw up his own will and set aside savings for his children, usually through investment in a stock portfolio or community fund. He may be taking out loans, too, to build the business side of his legacy.

Meanwhile, sexual relations with the spouse are deepening beyond the teenage exploratory phase, into more tantric or intimate levels where merging and blurring of boundaries occurs. In any case, whether we're dealing with marriage or business, the combinatory energy is greater than the sum of individual parts.

Deep transformation and experiences with the divine or astral realms are common now. The time of year resonating with this psycho-social stage is Halloween time or Samhain—holidays that embrace death (of the ancestors or of the ego) and thinning between the veils of two worlds.

In the early teen years, masked balls and parties signified the initial development of the ego and how it can be employed to connect with the teen's Heart energy. There, the mask represents the creative ego we use to interface with potential partners and community members.

Now we adopt the Halloween mask, signifying that behind the ego is an egoless creative void, a Godhead which the ego must submit to and merge with. In this merging process, the ego loses itself but accesses greater pools of energy, some of which may be dark, wild, taboo or "uncivilized."

Once the ego returns and comes back online, the individual integrates these primal energies into an increasingly mature ego that can drive the collective to new heights.

Jude the Obscure by Thomas Hardy would be considered an extreme dramatization of this psycho-social stage of development.

The Sagittarius Years

As the individual enters their middle 20s, there's an extreme infusion of optimism and faith. They perceive an exit out of the dark tunnel of their early 20s, where they neither occupied the innocence of late teenhood nor the experience of a 30-year-old.

At this stage, we are ready to spread the Good Word, like a country preacher, about the estate and legacy we've been building.

Anecdotally, a lot of people refer to 25 as their best year. The brain is like a Ferrari, operating at a fully-developed level now, yet still very fresh. Oftentimes the individual will get a promotion at this time, or simply get their first "real job," i.e. a job that recognizes their special talent.

But more generally the individual is supported by a feeling of buoyancy and levity: he sets his sights on a distant horizon and happily marches towards it, confident that his belief system can help him weather any future dark time. Indeed, prior to this, he would be at a loss to formulate a cohesive belief system at all—it existed more as a hazy mess of experiences.

Again, at this developmental stage, our brain's ability to synthesize is working on all cylinders. We are ready to engage with and philosophize about massive institutions. Courts, legislatures, publishing houses, PR firms, churches, market bazaars, trading floors and graduate school are all approachable by the individual now. He needs these larger communities in order to grow the estate or belief system he's been assembling and to spread the word about it.

All of these massive environments bring the individual in touch with people from outside the city—many may be from a foreign land. This makes philosophizing all the more important, in order to approach the new network with a sense of abundance, tolerance and broad-mindedness. If the other person isn't literally foreign, they may seem foreign by virtue of the fact that they inhabit a system with a language and culture all its own, like the legal system.

Though it may seem like an odd assortment of systems—from churches to colleges to courts—the common thread is that they all seek to broaden the horizons of man, by expanding his mind and spirit while also preserving liberty.

The mid-20s individual has rights and acumen, and he wishes to project these as safely but as widely as possible.

Such institutions facilitate that expansion, and they mirror it with their openness. For example, unlike an elite roundtable that makes decrees, US Congress and the Supreme Court operate according to votes. Legislative power, not executive power.

This is the quintessential "holiday spirit," a season of life that relates to Thanksgiving, to bounty and getting fat. Like embers and sparks from a late fall campfire, we hold tight to the optimistic faith that will carry us through the winter.

The individual may undertake a period of exotic or faraway travel in order to broaden his horizons and test the validity of his blossoming belief system and optimism.

24-year-old Biddy in Charles Dicken's *Great Expectations* represents this psycho-social stage: wandering on her own journey (she's an orphan) she musters optimism and a sense of personal moral code to found an institution of learning. Her unkemptness represents the rambling, adventurous spirit of this stage: there's no time to neatly comb hair when one is kindling a hopeful fire inside.

The Capricorn Years

In their late 20s, people generally appear to fall back on the belief system developed in the previous stage—because now it seems like the entire world is against them. How can they make it to 30, with all this mounting responsibility and anxiety?

There is a strange asceticism now, even if just devotion to a particular project, as the individual strips away any superfluous features in the way of their ultimate achievement. They may say "no" more than "yes": pessimism works as a hedge against nihilism until the individual can ensure their emotional bottom line is absolutely met.

Ancient culture and pop culture is obsessed with this age range, whether it's in the form of Hamlet or Siddhartha or the "27 Club" of musicians. But for good reason: this period is typified by austerity, rigorous challenges and lengthy trials. No one is coddling you anymore. The collective demands you develop some sense of authority and mastery, however small.

This developmental stage confronts you with the strictures of Society and offers up challenges that compel you to individuate through the acceptance of responsibility. There is a reckoning with the matrix of meta-codes that order society. It's a test to see if you can make your personal story congruent with the collective narratives that dramatize unspoken norms.

These narratives pop up everywhere, from politics to the post office. We call them "normal life." Think of the tiniest meta-codes, like, "Here's how to wash your body and promote cleanliness in your community."

Don't think this is a meta-code overseen by larger societal entities? Did you live through 2020 at all? We had every gas station and grocery store bathroom literally telling us, like a Nanny State nag, how to wash our damn hands.

Of course, these meta-codes stack on each other to create pyramidal hierarchies of meaning, and from a bird's-eye view you can trace a route from "clean your room" to "here's how you get married and promote generational continuity in your community."

But isn't someone behind the curtain of all these narratives? Surely, "normal life" isn't just a mix of happenstance and DNA playing out a competitive game.

Wise men are typically behind the curtain, consciously organizing the unspoken meta-codes into hierarchies of meaning that resonate with divinity. Social reality is like a really good pop song: it just hits; you don't think about the labor and the magic it requires.

Thus, the bulk of us float through youth, thinking we understand everything as we say, "It is what it is." Then, we feel a sudden need to take responsibility for our life direction as age 30 (and mortality) strikes on the clock.

That inches us a little closer to why this stage represents an adult individual confronting the issue of whether his actions matter at all in the grand scheme.

But to get a fully satisfying answer, let's pause here for a special deep dive. This will be key for understanding later discussion of societal decay.

The Keystone Chapter: How Our Story Holds Together

In traditional societies, individuals facing their late 20s are reaping rewards from solidification and maturation. For all their hard work to instantiate a family legacy through children, business, art or all of the above, they are rewarded with a lifetime of honor—indeed, their name will echo through the generations.

At this developmental stage, the individual is deeply searching for meaning, and he is bound to work out a personal story that jives with the collective stories in his community.

But these collective stories first arise when an elite roundtable lays out and organizes hierarchically all the meta-codes for the town, city, region. Myth, story and entertainment are like heat rippling above summer pavement, rising up from the background hierarchies of meaning.

The purpose of such roundtable efforts is to ensure the individual feels oriented and stable within his community across successive generations. Indeed, the roundtable oversees all the stories of the previous developmental stages we've discussed, as well as the social environments which these stages hint at.

The council members also interface with other roundtables from adjacent regions and even distant countries, in order to ensure peace across geo-political lines. After all, you don't want your nation's family to be constantly on edge. You want prosperity and continuity of experience.

This developmental stage is like a keystone, holding the human story together across generations. Or, like the mountain goat upon the peak, it seeks to implement hierarchies of meaning that are permanent, immutable and Eternal.

The divine hierarchies that ensure societal cohesion are abstract, and so their external appearance is a subliminal form. Again, most individuals only know them through ritual, narrative, custom or "common sense."

Furthermore, it would be pointless for the roundtable to invite individuals who haven't at least passed through the ordeals of the late 20s.

This passage requires deep sacrifice and often involves harsh setbacks with authority or a father figure. When the seasoned individual approaches the

roundtable, he does so with a scar—the record and badge of his worthiness. Peeling back the layers of society, as the roundtable does, requires nerves of steel.

There is a sternness in the air, at this table of scar-bearing men. Any false move could be like a mountain goat slipping from a high icy peak and plunging to his death. In other words, if the hierarchies of meaning don't support successive generations, they will lack a stable context in which to express their purpose.

Foresight is paramount here, and all hierarchical principles derive from a real or implied context of scarcity, much like the icy mountain climate.

Principles cannot initially be developed from a context of abundance, because while man, like the mountain goat, must always aim for the best—well, simultaneously, he must always prepare for the worst.

The epic of Gilgamesh, for example, was a story whose meaning coordinated the stability of several Near East societies. Indeed, tablets about Gilgamesh were copied across generations. Among other things, it is a story about man's mortality, and about farmers keeping wilderness at bay.

At one point, Gilgamesh addresses a council of elders, but true to the epic genre, the drama is immersive and larger than life.

There is no good reason for the common man to need anything more than story or epic myth. He does not need to be explicitly aware of arcane hierarchies of meaning, to analyze them or even expect that he be invited to the table. That is a recipe for stress, murderous insurrection, mob chaos and confusion.

Rather, this stage confronts us with the Matrix, and as the average person nears age 30, he simply works out a personal story that meshes with prevailing norms. Those who can't do this will often become loners, rebels or straight up anti-social.

Regular folk are encouraged to bond with this supra-structure of meaning, rather than band together over some half-baked zealous revolutionary ideas.

Everybody follows the rules and gets a modicum of freedom as their treat, served alongside security, the main course. Thus, most people slot themselves into mundane, simulated versions of this Uber-Hierarchy of meaning, such as pecking

orders at school, work and military. "Adulting" is considered a process of embracing this.

Taken to a corrupt extreme (like in the present day) these structures become carceral, as they condition communities to climb fabricated linear hierarchies and to sacrifice even their modicum of freedom.

In this corrupt climate, man becomes an imprisoned rat chasing little hits of acceptance, validation and neurochemical release distributed by supply chains of meaning. He shapes his worldview around pre-made thought-forms, curated lifestyles and material pleasures—all of which are on tap via the supply chains bundled by government and Big Biz.

This man cheers when his bowl of earned gruel is bigger than his neighbor's. He will spend his years unconsciously living in fear of the manufactured scarcity around him, obsessing over sex and dominance, imagining himself king of some relative hill. True meaning eludes him.

Of course, humans are stubborn, and expecting them to be ready for utopia overnight is asking a bit much. In that way, the roundtable of elders acts as a very important guardrail until a visionary vanguard can offer a workable alternative to the punishment/reward paradigm.

You see, if a stern but benevolent roundtable is behind the curtain, it is not necessarily cruel for them to put the mass of mankind in a narratological matrix. Keeping everyone in their lane protects all involved, and most may even prefer it.

But, from a long-term perspective, an increasingly-constrictive societal matrix becomes downright unethical, especially when there's a growing vanguard ready organize tribes around a state of experimentation, liberty and self-determination.

The limitations and implied scarcity of the roundtable matrix should always guide the historical trajectory towards more freedom and mastery, not less.

At this point, our roundtable masters do not serve us—they serve only themselves. What we call hierarchy today is merely a propaganda machine harvesting our time. It does not give us more time or generational legacy, as it is intended to do.

Rather, our meta-codes have been parasitized by degeneracy and psychopathic corruption, with the result that our collective narratives show blatant disrespect for the nuclear family and the sovereign individual.

We cannot merely "clean house" or build a "better, newer, just slightly different" overarching hierarchy of meaning. Corruption and decay has permanently displaced the synchronized context under which these stable narrative principles were designed to operate—which took centuries upon centuries to develop.

It is a major extinction-level moment for the part of our consciousness related to the "adult" developmental phase. We have the Sahara now: a better boat will do us no good.

In other words, we're not going back to a "normal" society, where a collective context retains continuity across time and space. An asymmetrical, desynchronized, non-linear experience of reality is sweeping the world.

Indeed, the social environment that is analogous to this psychological stage can be compared to mechanics of a giant watch, eternally ticking behind the pageantry of day-to-day life. Roundtable men should tamper with the cogs and gears only to ensure the public abides in a context of societal wholeness. Suffice it to say, recent tampering has had no such positive objective in mind.

For example, education was once considered one of the highest goods of a nation, because it facilitated successful kids returning to their home community and reinvesting in it.

Now all of that has been exploded, thanks to an influx of lifestyle propaganda, bloated administrative hierarchies and municipal fecklessness. The public school model is in disarray, the value of college is questionable, the sexual marketplace is global-digital and the young work force is nomadic.

In the previous year (2020) I devoted my Twitter account to detailing the world historical activity happening to the sphere of our society that represents leadership. Essentially, the heavy bills coming due for corrupt executive leadership—or glaring absence of strong leadership in common men—is resulting in deconstruction of the hierarchies of meaning that order society.

Soon, starting in 2021, we will be able to patch together enduring rubble from exploded hierarchies. Society will be aware of how it lacks wholeness, spurring radical combinations of meaning.

The nuclear family must learn how to work with local vanguards or tribes in order to thrive, too—no overarching leader can protect them for generations.

As I hope you are now starting see from this section, it's important to know not only where we're going but where we're coming from.

The overall paradigm operant in society will be very much like the next developmental stage we're going to discuss (the early 30s), with some caveats and flourishes that I'll elaborate on in Part Two and Part Three.

The next developmental stage is very experimental: indeed, we might even say it represents an anti-paradigm, because it is so decentralized, horizontal and non-linear.

The Aquarius Years

Now that the individual has crossed the threshold of 30, something changes. He feels his legacy is secure in some way, and thus he experiences an uncanny freedom.

At this stage, people begin to weigh out progressively more complex philosophical ideas, like charity, altruism and futurism. Scientific and technological advancements dominate attention, as do humanitarian paradigms. The intellectual intensity of this stage is so high that we see speculative endeavors such as quantum physics, virtual reality and avant-garde movements.

In other words, beyond the strictures of the late 20s is a whole new world full of radical freedom, opportunity and limit-breaking.

Because an individual's material needs are largely met at this stage, he's preoccupied with using newfound advancements to push society along a positive trajectory. He may assemble fascinating new value propositions, such as the Declaration of Independence.

Indeed, there is an experimental, *ad hoc* quality to this developmental stage. The individual is not guaranteed to be alive to see the fruits of his propositions, so he is often in the mental space of "Tomorrow." To ponder "what could be," he is extrapolating from current variables.

The individual's frame of reference is primarily generational: "How might my community look in 100 years? What can I do to maximize the freedom and happiness of those successive generations, despite not being related to them by blood?"

Full of this egoic confidence and creative energy, the individual sets out to network in a way he never has before. Simultaneously, his status is increasing in clubs that he chooses to affiliate with. People know him through his associates, and he gladly breaks bread with anybody, as long as it can advance his cause—or, at the least, stimulate his idealistic mind.

Incredible tolerance, dialog and rational scrutiny are keywords here. The funny thing is that, as the individual exhausts himself by frequenting wider circles, up to a global level, he actually *attracts more* power and material gain, as if he were a nexus of change—though, paradoxically, once these social gains cross his checkpoint for restructuring, they largely move on to benefit the collective, not himself.

For example, because the individual is highly developed at this point, he may invest newly-accrued resources in ways that benefit the children of others and not just his own.

Commissions, affiliate bonuses, dividends and other cliquish renumerations are the social mechanisms associated with this psychological stage.

The individual is prepared to think outside the box—social mores be damned! "It's all for the greater good anyways," the responsible rebel tells himself.

Though it's not a fictional example, the life of physicist Richard Feynman in his early 30s is very indicative of this stage. He was busy propagating a vanguard theory all while seamlessly drifting from one communal living situation to the next. Meanwhile, his sexual tastes were unorthodox at this time, ranging from undergrads to prostitutes to married swingers.

In modern poetry, we might look to *Howl* as an example of this psycho-social stage, written and performed when Allen Ginsberg had crossed age 30.

The Pisces Years

In his middle 30s, early Western man was facing death. His earlier flirtations with charity and altruism now completely dominate his consciousness.

In contrast to the hectic socializing of the previous stage, this is one of solitude, review, contemplation, acceptance, gratitude and sacrifice. Even in the modern age with our longer lifespans, mid-30s individuals may experience a metaphorical death as they receive a massive infusion of destiny and begin to contemplate every stage of development up until this point—after which they get a new lease on life. It was mentioned earlier, for example, that you cannot become president in America until after age 35.

But, back to early Western man: the ailing individual may be placed in hospice care or spend much time isolated in a hospital, monastery or church. A modern and healthy individual may go on a retreat, even inwardly, to review life chapters.

Life slows down while simultaneously becoming more expansive and elastic as the individual opens himself up to the Great Beyond.

Transcendence and solitude are keywords here. The individual may be compelled to do good deeds in secret or even in thought, via prayer and forgiveness.

The cosmic round is coming full circle. There is a sense of life being "on hold" as past, present and future mix together. Mutability flushes out everything, as good and bad swirl in one large vital soup.

This psycho-social stage is represented by 36-year-old Faramir in *Lord of the Rings*: after a retreat from battle, he is considered dead, put on a funeral pyre but then rescued and sent to convalesce at the Houses of Healing. His character is focused on the meaning of "retreat" in all senses.

It is from here that we start the round over again and experience the early survival and childhood stages once more, this time from a renewed adult perspective.

Each successive round signals another rebirth, and so throughout life we continually become a psycho-social representation of who we already are at a soul level.

Part Two: Movements

…Or: *Understanding how meta-codes support the nuclear family, and why intersexual, intergenerational war arises in the wake of meta-code deconstruction.*

Good Deal, Bad Deal

The collective or State wants stable sexual polarity to keep serving a future societal legacy. In these instances, 1 + 1 = 3, due to the fact that merging creates a unique supra-property called growth potential.

The State understands the need for individuals to face institutional limits. They don't want people to get all amped up on energetic reservoirs, then start wreaking havoc and cashing out, Bonny and Clyde-style or Bernie Madoff-style.

You saw hints of this in the 60s—"Make Love Not War"—where expansive sexual energy was seen as a protest against the delimiting action of a standardized conformist society.

It sounds a bit cynical, doesn't it? That, traditionally, the State only wants people to get married—and makes divorce difficult—because it likes to siphon off the excess energy generated by the male-female sexual polarity.

But consider this: Not only did the State provide you with something great in return, such as an ethical societal order that protects you when you're old or injured. This circumscription of individual power, and the norm of enforced monogamy, was also for the protection of both individuals and the collective.

In the progressive story outlined above, we spoke in detail about the psycho-social stage relating to sexual initiation and rather innocent exploration of newly-developed bodies.

This exploration was kept to a reasonable minimum: while some may have needed more hookups to find the right partner, many would've been paired with their "high school sweetheart" from the familiar local community (this was echoed in "Blue Velvet" as well).

What followed this stage was the construction of 1-on-1 relationships mediated by a third party, i.e. monogamous marriage as enshrined by a state-sponsored contract.

As the individual entered subsequent stages, his free will may have been more circumscribed but, paradoxically, his power would've also increased. There is a compound energetic charge arising from a deepening intimacy between newlywed couples, which not only results in progeny but a stable meta-code upon which larger societal formations can be built, like a town or city.

While the State kept these energetic currents in check through certain deterrents and norms—again, monogamy only and anti-divorce—it also offered incentives and "bonuses" for compliance.

I'm speaking of things like a social safety net, a regulated but growing investment pool (like a stock market) and protection for the progeny/legacy that resulted from intimate unions (both financial and sexual unions).

In other words, the State protected itself against an insurgent Resistance because its moral codes—much like asset-backed securities—were guaranteed by the most powerful energy known to human culture: male-female sexual polarity.

Likewise, in exchange for propping up societal cohesion with their circumscribed energy, couples received the dividends and the protection of a flourishing culture.

But the fact is, the modern State has reneged on this deal. Today, a feckless middle management class supports a corrupt psychopathic elite in offering neurochemical release and "acceptance" to us regular folk, who are conditioned to chase manufactured scarcity while climbing linear hierarchies.

The modern State is in the business of cranking out centralized identities or circumscribed worldviews, and its elevator pitch goes like this: "You too can have (relative) power and meaning and status and legacy and great sex…if you just buy this brand-new car! Or if you get this degree, or have this social media following or…"

In the sexual energy sector, we're now seeing the negative downstream or ripple effects of this unethical social mismanagement. We're witnessing an intersexual, intergenerational war that is quite seriously tearing society apart.

While this attenuation of monogamy may seem like a rah-rah moment for Free Love, consider that an awful lot of people feel anxiety because they're in the passenger seat when it comes to handling their sex drive. They're on go-go-go mode until they hit some burnout wall.

This is the paradox of the upcoming Patchwork Age. We are headed for unparalleled freedom, but it won't be checked by meta-codes and meta-narratives that are dying a permanent death now.

You cannot just sweep the corruption out of our present hierarchies and have them be like a clean house. The parasitical corruption has permanently displaced the context for which these hierarchical principles are designed.

Our collective teleology is no longer focused on making nuclear families the endgame of society. We make it hard to build a family and for the sexes to enjoy any semblance of "normal" romance.

By extension, from these ashes we won't rebuild a monogamy-based hierarchy that's "better and just a little different than before." No stable context will be present for that endeavor, either—but that doesn't mean monogamy is doomed.

We will have to find new ways to organize sexual energy and families. It's true that people will still desire monogamy. Women will still select mates from male hierarchies, albeit ones that are smaller, local and likely to rearrange ranks at a moment's notice, almost defeating the definition of hierarchies altogether.

In the context of upcoming chaos, one day's "strength" is the next day's "liability," giving rise to constantly shifting preferences and values.

Traditional male hierarchies—ones supported by an overarching societal context—will struggle to form and stabilize in these fluid localized environments that appease buyers more than sellers.

So the solution to bonded sexual relations will evolve organically in the moment, I believe, almost *ad hoc*.

Lacking a universal macro hierarchy that transcends geographic and generational lines, we will have to appeal to our best selves, relying partly on remembered tradition but also on an acceptance of new local tribal contexts.

The risk is that fear urges us to reassert a more tyrannical version of old, sensible macro constraints whose supportive historical context is crumbling now.

Brave New World, indeed.

The Crumbling Capricorn Context: Sex is War, War is Work

Millennials—particularly those 30-somethings born in the early 80s—have seen their romantic inclinations strangely devolve into warfare over jobs, instead of naturally evolving into a patriarch/mother role.

Remember, too, that 1982-83 was an austere bear market, creating a karmic imprint of scarcity. It was also a time of the rising "divorce on-demand" market—a reflection of the "mutually assured destruction" between Russia and the US.

Since that moment, we have seen romantic relations in the West become increasingly transactional. Likewise, we've seen a spike in "boss babe" propaganda. The millennial generation has inherited a context in which sex is war and war is work.

These men and women are the middle deck in a triple-decker generational context—they're wedged between Zoomers and Boomers.

Thus, the millennial male's socio-sexual war is having ripple effects on the male generations below and above them. It is taking the natural competitiveness of job markets, which actually has a cooperative effect in male circles, and accelerating that into winner-take-all nuclear domination.

Boomers are fighting to stay relevant, hoping to pad out their retirement portfolios. Zoomers are keeping up via digital savvy, but their real-life social and dating skills are suffering as a result.

You wonder why 2020 turned out to be so crazy? A major reason why is this careerist warfare between sexes within the millennial generation, which is producing cross-generational dissonance. The chickens came home to roost. We've replaced love and societal cohesion with a nightmarish festival of cruelty.

Decades of misguided socio-sexual customs are producing radioactive waste, leaking into every facet of "normal" life. We cannot even carry on a genuine conversation together, because we're too busy trying to get gratification "on demand." My job title, my political hot take, my follower count, my notch count, my my my…

Even in the best of circumstances, this triple-decker context would require utmost cooperation.

In America, the millennials came of age during the traumatic 9/11 Era, precisely when Zoomers were being born. At this point, the mature Older Brother millennials will "hold the

flame" and transmit the meaning of this traumatic generational story to Zoomers (who are now in bloom), as a way to maintain cross-generational cohesion.

But not every millennial has reached this level of maturity and mastery. Fact is, many millennials are still processing their own pain, and their rocky relationship with their Boomer parents, who experienced a more prosperous 30s.

What happened in recent decades is this: the propaganda of selfishness was injected into the once-reliable infrastructure of meaning, which I call supply chains of meaning. In the section above titled "The Capricorn Years," we detailed how these chains are coordinated by a centralized executive class, who want hierarchies of meta-codes to deliver societal cohesion. Most of these supply chains appear in the form of myth, story or lifestyle models.

Now, the injection of corrupted lifestyle models did juice the economy for awhile. It kept the supply chains surging day and night with on-demand meaning (no work or effort required to achieve existential understanding and alignment with one's community).

Yet the criminal impulse to attract profit by twisting meta-codes—by promoting consumer lifestyles over stable families and communities, for example—actually ended up causing the infrastructure of meaning to permanently break down over time.

On a long enough timeline, there is a reckoning point, and many would agree 2020 represented that point. Gunk accumulated in the supply chains gradually, though many ignored it—and then, poof, "normal" was suddenly gone one day.

On the bright side, as meta-codes crumble completely and displace the artificial public square of Consumerism, perhaps new and real in-roads for cross-generational cooperation will appear. Too many micro-narratives will be swirling around to support the totalized Branded Lifestyle World, which seeks to replicate Mini-Me's as copies of a centralized thought-form. You won't be able to find your community just by flashing a name brand on your T-shirt.

There will be some wild waves to surf before reaching cooperation, though. You might say unity will always exist as a horizon, never automatic or fully realized. Our impulse to get on each other's wavelengths will be born from a sense of Macro Narrative loss. We will ache upon realizing there is no longer a prescribed path to success and family.

In this chaotic state of affairs, the process of valuation will change radically, too, causing a permanent flux in power from tribe to tribe, as a strength one day becomes a liability tomorrow.

We might say that our collective valuation processes will be undergoing dramatic shocks. I'm talking unexpectedly deep and swift, like a preppy prom queen who turns into a blue-haired SJW after a weekend visit to Portland.

We need to learn how to navigate this energy, because it's going to affect our relationships with others.

Furthermore, it's going to affect our relationship with society, which for the past 20 years has existed as a collection of on-demand supply chains. These chains have severely broken down, to the point that the grand narrative holding them together is practically absent after 2020.

In the not-too-distant past people behaved and complied because a grand narrative was there to carry them throughout their day. Wake up. Turn off your "made in China" alarm clock. Grab your designer coffee. Wear your Amazon-delivered shoes. Drive your new car. Sing the company's jingle in your car. Say hi to the secretary. She waves back. She's had her designer coffee, too. Rinse. Repeat.

We're all losing a sense of stability because our prized "modern" values—including insta-gratification—are like a live wire on the ground, killing bystanders with the shock of meaninglessness.

Rebellion will mount when the common man feels threatened by an environment that once coddled him.

In many cases the values are changing because the supply is abruptly cut off. And vice-versa: sometimes an abrupt change in values leads to dramatically ending the supply. Angelic anarchy as men work for their collective dignity and not the bottom line of a few corrupted elite.

Either way, we'll see people fail when they portray societal problems as something that can fixed with an externally-managed supply chain. ("Healthcare for gig workers? Oh, just have the government handle it, or the board members, or…")

Patchwork is about the collective being infused with an intellectual-spiritual energy that encourages complete independence from systems it cannot manage.

Thus, as DIY self-sufficiency leads a multiplicity of tribes to adopt various endgames, some people could make a divine leap out of passive consumerism. Others may completely short-circuit, unable to see beyond the fast food life.

The tribal factor in this state of fluctuating values will lead to a fascination with possession, property and territory. These "territories" will be destabilized, too, and may exist in some hybridized way, half physical and half digital.

So the term Patchwork Age seems fitting: it conjures images of a jagged map that's being continually un-stitched and re-stitched together. What we're concerned with here is disrupted supply chains of meaning—and a chance to build and manage new ones, perhaps using pieces of old centralized ones (if not completely tainted by corruption).

The growing desire to participate only in systems it can manage will lead the Patchwork individual to work with other people who are similarly committed. That often means working with people outside one's "normal" tribe. Such is the power of a cause: unusual alliances formed over affinity for freedom.

But while the zealous may want to transition quickly into a quasi-utopia with patchworked DIY supply chains, there will be a pushback among the more traditional-minded to have this radical process enforce individual accountability.

When there's too much radical energy, the post-hierarchical, decentralized, horizontal impulse veers away from responsible democratic republics and into socialism. Radicals may even end up re-centralizing the remains of a de-centralized Old Order. That's why revolutions aren't all "peace n love."

The debate over values and how to manage meaning/vision through DIY supply chains will likely reverberate in a generational context. And people will certainly think their wrongs make a right. They will look to one group's endgame or aesthetic with disparagement, calling it a "cult." Although, it may very well be a cult.

As the masses realize that leaders won't save them, all sorts of "resources" (especially meaning) will be up for grabs but there will be no macro paradigm to enforce who gets what, as in the old days when you just snapped your fingers to receive a Branded Identity. In this state of affairs, personal integrity will matter.

Choose Your Tribe Wisely

Doubtless the Millennials and the Boomers will present the most contested and competing generational worldviews in the 2020s.

It'll be the Millennials with their crypto-financed croissants versus the Boomers who just want to grill and print endless fiat.

But I posit that these groups will engage in infighting as micro-communities splinter off to find increased freedom. Splinter factions will make the argument that some previously-ignored thing is now valuable and they'll organize their tribe around managing this new supply chain.

Now we get to the heart of the matter: the very act of finding one's tribe will be even more valuable than finding a resource to build that tribe upon.

Meaning will be the most valuable commodity after food, shelter and clothing are obtained. Trading with other tribes will be based on this principle.

Silicon Valley thinks personal data will be the new currency post-2020. I believe that spiritual resources will be the preeminent Patchwork Age commodity.

Guys in the early 2000s would literally say that retirement paradise must include on-demand TV. Who needed meaning in this environment?

Well, that consumerist paradise died a harsh death in the 2020s. Look for entities like Amazon to go overboard with their embrace of "the little guy" and "niche merchants."

A kind, hip, "more meaningful" Amazon. Gross.

The rapid swings and fluctuation in values will accelerate and amplify the disarray overtaking once-stable divisions like economic classes, turning them into fluid, high-velocity slipstreams. Likewise, notions of art and doing business will be swept up in this process, as will dating.

Does a good or service or relationship participate in building a new world, as defined by your vision? That's how valuation will start to proceed now.

There's great opportunity to be found here but also great danger.

Just watch how trad lifestyles will turn on a dime to embrace the hipster ethos. Imagine what it does to the unconscious self-worth of Ivy Leaguers when they're sent home during a pandemic because they're "inessential workers." They're going to dust off old concepts like unionizing and declare themselves valuable again. They are going to search for meaning and construct supply chains around it, so they can form new a tribe.

You better believe that the service industry wage earners and the aimless Ivy Leaguers are going to lock arms and march over an already-dead Old System—just so they can directly manage an even more centralized but "socially hip" New System of UBI and taxes on out-group tribes. I'm already generating a label for this unfortunate Patchwork movement: "the Neo-Totalitarians of Cool." Freedom for me but not for thee.

You're seeing some hints of this new alliance through online sex work like Only Fans (or in hybrid forms like Seeking Arrangement), where degreed women request certain social and labor protections for their employment. This trend will ramp up, as will debates around so-called "double standards." Subsequently, the neural pathways around pleasure and relationships will be molded for large swathes of people, seriously hindering the opportunity for objective conversations with disagreeable tribes.

It will be a spiritual crisis moment, spurred by inflation and automation and unusual alliances.

But some individuals could turn the hipster penchant for inverted values into compassionate resourcefulness.

Consider all the hip farm-to-table restaurateurs who are closing shop in NYC, ostensible capital of the world. You think they'll just throw away their value?

No, they'll scatter in Patchwork fashion to former Industrial Boom towns all across the country and revitalize those communities with hospitality.

True, insufferable hipsters are going to come out of the woodwork and resuscitate macramé with woke ethnic designs. They'll sell these wares on suburban sidewalks, too, inviting angry NextDoor comments from their conservative-voting Boomer neighbors.

Either way, hipsters are at your local gates now—and they're ready to colonize, for good or for ill.

We might even have to fight for a truly free Internet after 2020, lest the general e-shopping experience feel like neo-unionism.

As hipsters colonize e-commerce spaces in the 2020s, they'll find novel ways to enforce resource allocation.

You thought the hipster wave had crested? No, it's just getting started in the Patchwork Age. Really, you haven't seen anything yet.

Inflection Point

Let's stay focused on that keystone stage of psycho-social development, where an individual really faces limitations set forth by the meta-codes he lives under.

Man is a Fallen Individual who has an evolutionary challenge to harmonize with his surroundings. His trajectory is to restore Earth as close as possible to an Edenic state of liberty and prosperity, in preparation for what theologians call the Second Coming and what scientists call the Singularity. That trajectory was clearly augmented—and altered—during the Enlightenment, Revolution, Victorian and Modern Ages.

The mistake made was in thinking that the restoration of post-Edenic Man is supposed to occur along the lines of domination and control of events—which is essentially a corruption of the cosmic justice principle entrusted to the roundtable.

It is my belief that this roundtable corruption has led to a modern construction of the Tower of Babel over the past 250 years. This trajectory reached an inflection point in 2020, where meta-codes were permanently blown to smithereens, due to a displacement of the context under which they thrive.

Modernity, in its drive to "make truth new," has essentially never escaped the agrarian codes founding society. It has only led to Post-Modernity, where "truth is dead." Meanwhile, the stories encoded in our DNA—those agrarian codes—tell us something is off in everything from work to romance. It's like these codes can't express themselves in such a distorted context that eschews tradition and continuity across space and time.

The contemporary executive roundtable class—Chamath Palihapitiya, founder of Social Capital, claims it consists of 150 men—has used Enlightenment thinking and social revolutions, occult research and mass media propaganda to build what I call the modern Tower of Babel. This tower is a highly-advanced supra-structure that is both social and metaphysical, a global village that is essentially "the Matrix."

It is no secret anymore that government, business and roundtables of various elite have teamed up to manage this tripartite complex comprising science, the occult and symbolic programming. What seems like the plot to an action movie has been revealed quite clearly in declassified US government documents and in the degenerate trajectory of the arts, advertising, politics, religion and schooling.

There is even speculation that the global elite is a Saturn Cult who wants to harvest human dependency and fear—again, much like "The Matrix." If so, they are probably a multi-generational cabal aware of cosmic cycles; they hijacked these cycles and took advantage of them for self-serving purposes.

This has forced a reckoning upon us, because all of this essentially breaks laws of cosmic justice, which seeks to create stable societies through cross-generational hierarchical management of meta-codes and meta-narratives.

Yes, in a perverse but awe-inspiring way, the higher-ranking upper crust elite have used the military-industrial complex to build one of the most complex governed societies in the world. However, they have done this through psychopathic corruption, with the aim of recouping the lion's share of rewards, control and power. As Palihapitiya also said in an interview, these elite men manage society for the purpose of enriching their own bloodlines. They have no interest in propagating narratives the support the common man's nuclear family.

Myths and meta-codes serve the critical function of placing human consciousness within a hierarchical context: in other words, to humans, not all types of meaning are created equal. Thus, by extension not all men are equal in practice even though all men deserve to be treated with equal dignity.

One man's consciousness may attract him to a type of meaning that puts him in frequent contact with sources of food, and so he becomes a humble farmer or chef. Another man may become a rock star. Revealing the reasons for this difference in consciousness is the task of fields like astrology.

But when the executive management of human consciousness becomes disconnected from the purpose of building stable and progressively freer societies, then that management is subject to the law of entropy. Myths will inevitably return to their life-giving aspect; they will return to mapping the progression of individual development within the context of the firm but compassionate human family, whose protection takes priority above all other concerns.

These corrupt managerial classes will break down just at the moment they claim to be Eternal and allied with the common man. "This isn't Trump's Supreme Court nominee," the media class tells the masses it secretly despises. "This is *your* nominee." They will take down the Babel supra-structure as they fall, too, so intertwined is their parasitical influence with the structure's operation.

Thus, the glue holding together all of our societal systems has lost its hold. Rather than becoming more permanent, these systems decayed as a result of delivering false meaning "on demand." True, supply chains of meaning are intended to dole out roles and worldviews, but only after the individual applies patient effort and sacrifice. Pre-fabricated roles require no effort from the individual. What they give in terms of pleasure and temporary meaning, they take in terms of autonomy. This upsets cosmic balance and proportion.

In other words, what we thought of as Eternal is actually breakable: as it turns out, collective meaning must be continually tended, observed by watchdogs, untainted by corruption across time, lest someone displace the social contexts that support these hierarchical principles.

Hierarchy may be encoded in our DNA via natural evolution or even epigenetics. But consider the advanced world we labor under, where DNA is merely a plaything and social consciousness a plastic toy that can be manipulated. We cracked both the Nature and Nurture side of the hierarchy equation, and our environments became a programmable experiment for elite.

In 2020, we reached an inflection point in this experimental corruption process. Meta-codes and meta-systems were completely detonated.

What will occur is a sense of total loss as we sift through the rubble, searching for those bits that endure and remain untainted by corruption. In some sense, we will always need some kind of governance and hierarchy. But as I'll soon outline, I would struggle to define what's coming as hierarchy at all—it's more like a post-hierarchical society.

We will combine enduring pieces in infinite new ways, to build out a radically free, local, tribalized, decentralized Patchwork society. It is already happening now, in our dissensus-fueled world. We walk around the ruins of Babel's Tower, unable to communicate, ready to pursue various endgames with anybody who'll join our vision—even a vision that tries to recreate or return to Tradition.

And so in the next section I'm going to focus specifically on additions made to the Tower of Babel during the 20th century, as it almost reached completion and total domination over the material world and human consciousness.

The Tower of Babel

Just because the Tower has fallen doesn't mean we're in the clear. There will be many generations of clean up and letting certain processes (like, say, vengeful feminism) run out of gas. But it's certain we're no longer on the path to a more totalized, centralized world. There's just too much desynchronization for that to occur.

I'm not knocking those who push the "return to tradition" narrative, by the way. It's just that a sick elite has a material domination addiction, and this reached its peak during the 20th century, permanently destroying the context under which "tradition" could be the dominant Macro Narrative.

Thus, we'll only see traditionalism in pockets, as a type of Patchwork defiance or even as Amish-style communes. This will actually be an incredibly important tribe to stay in touch with, as we have to patch together a new, increasingly local food system due to extreme weather, fluctuating prices and new regulations around interstate trade or subsidization.

Cultural dialectics is the best way to understand how the modern Tower of Babel was constructed. Every time cross-generational unity was achieved—usually during a gruesome war or other calamity—a division was manufactured through alterations to the social or lifestyle environment.

Let's start with World War One, which broke apart the power concentrated among the noble-blooded aristocrats—those sticklers in between the malleable middle class and the tip top elite.

The fighting commenced in 1914, kicking off a roughly 40-year cycle of austerity and loss. In that span of time, European countries went from having a politically-relevant monarchic class to an absence of them in seats of power.

Many refer to World War One as an "international banker's war"—hints of the roundtables becoming corrupt and nepotistic. This terrifying event produced many artists who saw senselessness in the great loss of life. Hemingway was one writer who tried to artistically represent "grace under pressure" as a way to create cross-generational unity. Both young and old read his books to this day.

America then went into the Great Depression—a strange experience of generational cooperation, because people soon realized they were all in a sorry state together. There was

another terrific external event which coordinated unity and advertised the value of security: that is, the stock market crash.

Following upon the Depression we had World War Two. In 1947, in the war's aftermath, there was a "baby boom" or the start of the infamous Boomer Generation. But concurrent with this cycle was a movement that killed off personal style at a mass level. We entered a conformist era of mass-produced consumer goods and complacent suburban living. The common man's eyes were still trained on "security," but from the antithesis of consumption rather than saving.

This set up a nice dialectic, so that the suburban Baby Boomers would rebel ferociously upon coming of age around 1965. Instead of passing through any type of traditional ritual like we outlined above, we witnessed the birth of "teenager culture."

In the place of ancient virginity festivals, labor rituals and grain sacraments, we saw the birth control pill, LSD (which is synthesized from rye) and the rise of computerized automation. Young people "dropped out" and found their "tribe" in this chaotic environment. Meanwhile, there was cross-generational awareness of Vietnam causalities via television broadcasts.

Once we reached an apex in the Cold War with Russia, the cultural dialectic was triggered again. The 80s Cold War was chilly, harsh diplomacy, indeed—that of mutually-assured destruction. Here in the States, we also saw mutually-assured destruction between the sexes: the divorce-on-demand trend began to grow.

In 1990-91, this bipolar order disappeared when the Berlin Wall fell and the Soviet Union broke apart, giving way to a globalist era. Boomers shook off their rebellion, had kids and boot-strapped their way into a Starbucks-fueled corporate job. Multinational companies grew and labor was outsourced to a global workforce. The World Wide Web debuted on August 6, 1991, further connecting the global village together.

But, of course, as the cultural dialectic always goes, this newfound unity was bound to divide into dualistic camps again: Boomers versus Millennials.

As the speed and confusion increased in the 20th century, bringing us closer to the 21st, what happened is something like "An Apocalypse in Three Acts."

Act One would've been 2000-1. First, this was the start of the consumerist Amazon Age. But, simultaneously, a dot com bubble burst and many artists were drawn to themes of rebellion against mindless consumerism and corporatocracies. Napster flourished, free online porn

exploded (especially amateur varieties) and nascent dating/social media sites like Make Out Club cropped up.

Of course, we can't forget the events of September 11, 2001, which produced a terrible calamity for all to see. We felt a brief hit of generational unity, and yet again, within that, there was a distinct division between the older conservative Boomers and the young Millennials who questioned the "security" of the surveillance state they were coming of age in.

In late 2007, we became increasingly aware of the coming mortgage meltdown and unemployment spike. This set us up for a long destruction of societal meta-codes. Act Two of the Apocalypse was well underway.

The Internet was also undergoing a dialectical growth pattern. AirBnB launched and Facebook took off, building on the 1991 seed promise of the Internet and a global society. Now that global society was becoming more nomadic, more multi-polar, more tribal. Online was no longer the redoubt of funky enclaves: one could exist there, and make money doing so.

We saw Millennials and their Boomer parents collectively realizing how the American Suburban Dream was crumbling. They stood on either side of this divide and began to hunker down with their respective tribes.

Act Two continued during the 2010s. We saw the astronomical rise of social media, protest mobs, riots, international violence and Big Tech/Big Brother dominance. If you didn't have a smartphone, you weren't a citizen—or such was the message. These were very dark times. Media was pumping all sorts of narratives encouraging fear and loathing. The personal generational divide was mirrored in a Left/Right political divide.

As media spectacles of tribal violence were broadcast (and possibly coordinated) in 2017—for example, the Charlottesville protests—a third and final act was near. Events like these revealed the corruption that had bled into our foundational meta-codes, displacing our stable societal context.

"Drain the swamp" became a rallying cry over the subsequent years (though many wondered if this was just more pacifying "hopium" in a hyper-consumerist, programmable society). All the sickness of a corrupt system was bringing down the entire house. The keystone shuddered. The pubic square went mad; witch hunts commenced, even against someone so innocent as Nick Sandmann, a smiling Covington Catholic student.

This led to 2020, a year that, by all measures, was simply stunning. It appeared that we were beginning a major generational cycle in which the sick elements of managerial systems could only be removed by complete detonation of the systems—that's just how deep the rot went. The cultural dialectic would have to be permanently ended, and it would take old contexts as it fell.

Honestly, leading up to the explosive year of 2020, think about how far we had displaced the context under which our basic hierarchical principles evolved: how in the world had it become possible, for example, for fresh-faced soccer moms to *willingly* virtue signal and take their kids to Drag Queen Story Hour at the local library? It wasn't just that our meta-codes were corrupt—our entire context for telling stories, the context for our narratologies, was sicker than sick. Absolute delusion and breakdown of the keystone of reason.

As you might assume, 2020 represents an epochal event. I've heard speculation that the pandemic, though real, is symbolic of a hidden war between factions in those modern elite roundtables who manage meta-codes for their own benefit. Or, to say it differently, the regional roundtables have been fighting.

I've also heard that the pandemic is symbolic of white hats taking these roundtables out—kind of like a holy revenge of the original roundtable Templar Knights. There sure were a lot of *very weird* occurrences in 2020, and one would do well to watch some of Pat Stedman's Periscope series titled "Covid/Cabal" for more information on this topic.

It's true we did see a lot of CEOs step down in early 2020. Had the gravy train run its course? Yes, I think there's a good chance the financial system has reached a point of no return, and we've been in the midst of a financial re-structuring/deconstruction that has geo-political and Deep State implications.

At the end of March, we were all sent home for "14 days to slow the spread." It appears that the late March breakdown and the subsequent "social distancing" narrative was a last-ditch effort for the cultural dialectic of domination and control, of "unity" via dualistic division. Some people began to question the fear, while others accused them of being "insensitive to the sick and dying."

The Tower of Babel officially snapped then, and smashed to smithereens in the autumn, preparing us for the multi-polar Patchwork Age.

Part Three: The United States of Consciousness

1.

The future belongs to those who can adapt old, obscure systems to radical new contexts.

2.

We have come to see society as a collection of on-demand supply chains.

3.

The Old World is ending now: a DIY landscape replaces it, full of self-managed supply chains.

4.

As our values become shocked and charged up, we will be compelled to externalize our inspiration.

5.

Fluctuating values will lead to new visions and these visions will lead to patching.

6.

Echo chambers will break down, and it will be a life-defining moment for many who are emotionally invested in having their entire identity tethered to their "club."

7.

In the Patchwork Age, there's simply too much "dissensus" energy and too many people thinking tribal breakdown can't happen to them.

8.

When homelessness prevails as a general societal state, the intellectually homeless may feel more "in the groove." They'll be more adaptable than others but not necessarily better off by virtue of that fact. Still, some may become the New Leaders in this state of affairs.

9.

Factions will keep splintering until all constituent individuals are scattered into solitude. Then everyone will see warring camps within themselves ad infinitum. We will be together, apart. A new aesthetic will be born from this Patchwork Consciousness.

10.

The New Patchwork Aesthetic will be not so much a Hive but more of an observable "frequency" that connects various nodes—it'll organically arise from the micro-narratives.

11..

The Capitol Hill Autonomous Zone is an example of what's to come. There will be all sorts of "reclaimed spaces"—online or otherwise—as Patchwork Consciousness is downloaded.

12.

Multiplication not Balkanization.

13.

After the forest fire of 2020, truth and beauty will sprout up in radical asymmetry on the ashes. A post-Conservative, post-Liberal patchwork of nomadic meaning is in store, recalling the Bible verse in Matthew: "And whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear your words, when ye depart out of that house or city, shake off the dust of your feet."

14.

Patchwork Consciousness is a harder sell than the dominant Pension Narrative, which is nice, neat and centralized. Even "wokeness" is merely a Pension Narrative, where there always seems to be enough Human Capital to make sure everyone is "seen."

15.

Asymmetry is on its way, and growing awareness of this will produce new calls for apolitical “unity.”

16.

Unity will never fully arrive, but people will seek to acknowledge that a dominant Macro Narrative has been replaced by a creative ferment of various endgames.

17.

Endgames don’t have to be antagonistic to each other, though tribalism may portray them as a threat.

18.

A lot of people are in “wait and see” mode. But soon they won't be able to deny that the Old Order is just ruins for anarchist squatters.

19.

The shattering is being paced so that a positive collective endgame can be sold.

20.

Have you heard of the theatrical concept of a "proscenium"? It gives the action a sense of there-ness The Old Proscenium is falling apart, sending us all into our micro. In the Patchwork Age we'll sense things are off: there'll be no stable context for our interactions. That's the lone macro realization.

21.

Through the absence of a stable communicative contexts (common agreements, etc.) we'll realize that we're all individual nodes who have to re-create the vectors that connect us.

22.

There will be an "all aboard" moment. A realization born of absence…and a sense that we're headed into a New World.

23.

We are Meme-Man now. Symbols and semiotics usurp so much emotional and cognitive bandwidth that they reach a degree of autonomy not suited for non-sentient forms…hence the reason Patchwork is coming. All the codes will become desynchronized, and we had a hand in that.

24.

All the old codes will be defunct, causing desynchronization across society, resulting in asymmetrical and localized zones of organization, both in physical & psychological senses.

25.

In the Patchwork Age, leaders sometimes show up on the scene as a "benevolent dictator."

26.

There will be a massive resurgence of cults, which naturally revolve around charismatic leaders/prophets but are sometimes just a loose collection of people high on a "cause."

27.

Since Patchwork can fractionate us down to the solo level, you'll see a return to saint-like experiences: extreme visions, encounters with angels, demons and even God.

28.

Tyler Durden said: "You are not your fucking khakis." An evolved Patchwork individual says: "You are not a centralized thought-form."

29.

A breakthrough via breakdown is coming.

Business, Politics and Aesthetics in the Patchwork Age

In the wake of 9/11, we saw a massive outburst of creative energy. A rock revival rallied on the year's earlier trend of sincere/heartfelt radio pop music. People cared about fiction again, both contemporary and classics. Philosophical discussions were had. Underground sites like Make Out Club and Only Undies Club pushed people to channel their libido into a form of decentralized networking. AOL Instant Messenger was an open platform, facilitating the carrying on of the conversation outside the limits of these pre-dating app platforms.

During this time, curiosity and nuance was in the air, in stark contrast to the "Us versus Them" wartime vibes. People were earnestly trying to connect in ways that showed respect for unique interests.

Moreover, these connections were crossing racial, class and identitarian lines. An emo scenester who reads Nietzsche and works out? A caring jock who's ahead of the curve with local, organic, home-cooked foods? Both of them hanging out? All these weird combinations of personal style were popping up, and people crossed clique lines just to find out what the hell was going on. It was a good time to go out and party. A jubilee moment, if you will.

This jubilee atmosphere was supported by a creative ferment of new and radical art that pushed against models of on-demand consumerism and listless boredom. It was rebellious and not merely disruptive.

Of course, we've just gone over the Three Acts of the Apocalypse, so we know how this story ended: a vanguard triumph wasn't in the cards. The Amazon Age launched a society that harvested not only dollars but also eyeballs, attention, personal identity and quality time. By the 2010s, the attitude was: "Don't have a Facebook account? Oh, you must not be a worthy person."

But that doesn't mean we can't learn from the rebellious early 2000s, in terms of what's coming down the pipe for art, business and social circles.

Frankly, the on-demand generational chapter is closing. We are saying hello to a new generational chapter in which the People—and not Profit—will have the upper hand in shaping the zeitgeist.

Artists are going to turn tech distribution channels against the so-called masters who created them for profit. As writer Thomas Bevan puts it, we will have analog artistic artifacts but with digital distribution as well as the formation of a new critic class.

Bye bye, gatekeepers!

In the Patchwork Age, this jubilee vibe is going to come back, but with a vengeance. Such friction will support a decentralized vision with defiant artifacts and radical modes of distribution.

Yes, a corrupt elite used their influence to build a dopamine-soaked behemoth—but now the tables turn. Is this perhaps the dawn of "ethical capitalism"? What radical, new, DIY supply chains of meaning could be born at this time?

To make some substantial speculations, let's take a closer look at the artifacts of 2000-2002. Though these artifacts may not have overcome the consumerist zeitgeist, they challenged it well and set us up for the new Patchwork Age.

As you might've guessed from my description of the early 2000s zeitgeist, there was an element of using tech/electronics for the purpose of creating defiant artifacts—what we might call "anti-commodities" or commodities whose primary value was meaning.

The opening salvo was Radiohead's *Kid A*, released on October 2, 2000.

Many were expecting *OK Computer* part two—you know, a little spacey but with plenty of hooks to sing along with.

On October 14, Radiohead made their first appearance on Saturday Night Live. I've read that the front row was full of celebs, SNL staff and bougie guests who hadn't experienced the full album yet, and were hoping to hear some "Karma Police"-type radio hit. Story goes, they had a frustrated collective "WTF" moment.

What happened is that Radiohead played "The National Anthem," a chaotic banger that had lead singer Thom Yorke manically panting into the mic. Meanwhile, guitarist Johnny Greenwood trotted out obscure electronic boxes and made them warble with curious delight.

That rebellious spirit trickled down into more underground scenes. There's a rapper in the UK called Craig David. He's also addicted to buying very expensive cars—seriously, he buys Lamborghinis on demand. So, in May 2001, an artist called Squarepusher parodied Craig David's compulsive buying and delusional status-seeking in a breakout single called "Red Hot Car."

The track simultaneously deconstructed an entire club music genre that had become more processed than a bag of Doritos. Upon the single's release, music magazine NME said it "renders the whole of the UK garage phenomenon redundant within five minutes of bendy electronic madness."

This is very much similar to how the upcoming Patchwork Age will shatter centralized genres and thought-forms with irreverent talent and experimental skill.

Stateside, in Atlanta, a one-man act called Prefuse 73 also made a mission statement that spring. He released an album called "Vocal Studies + Uprock Narratives." With song titles like "Radio Attack" and satirical soundbites like "program your playlist to sound the same," this artist was battling against commercial complacency.

Indeed, the song's second track, "Nuno," is a Patchwork collage that samples a Nas lyric: "Fuck words of wisdom." Prefuse 73 cuts up and re-stitches the lyric in multiple ways, patching together an anti-guru anthem. More punk than punk itself, this genre-breaking song ironically speaks to the importance of mastering your medium.

Of course, the most overt musical renaissance was happening with rock music. The White Stripes, The Strokes, The Walkmen and many others were adapting vintage amps to a radically new, Napster-infused context.

In my opinion, a standout moment in this trend occurred on February 2, 2002, when The Strokes played a concert for an episode of MTV's $2 Dollar Bill show.

It was a killer performance, yes, but it also short-circuited standard notions of consumer markets, as the audience reflected not just indie music fans but also people who simply liked music. At one point, Cody Chestnut, a black R&B musician from Atlanta, danced on stage with the band as they broke into "Last Nite."

The diversity totalitarians wish they could engineer an event as cool as this. But they won't ever get there, because it has to be authentic, genuine and organic.

The cosmic weather on that day featured so much changeful, open-minded energy that the electricity literally short-circuited in the venue temporarily, causing a delay in The Strokes' performance. Frontman Julian Casablancas—another practice-obsessed punk—closed out the concert by saying: "Rock 'n roll history." Twenty years later, the comment doesn't ring tongue-in-cheek—it rings true.

Meanwhile, *auteur* ("amateur" or indie) cinema was reflective of this musical explosion. In January 2001, *Donnie Darko* was released. This low-budget movie became a cult hit while simultaneously featuring well-known actors and actresses who normally would require top pay.

The plot made a risky gamble, too. The fracturing psyche of the protagonist is reflective of fracturing that takes place in his local community, which itself is reflective of fracturing timelines in the cosmic realm. Frankly, that's a pure Patchwork Age narrative.

Smack in the middle of 2001, *Ghost World* represented yet another generational story about the loss of collective meaning: we watch as a high school loner falls for a jaded 30-something shut-in.

At year's end, this fracturing narrative was also dramatized in *The Royal Tenenbaums* by Wes Anderson, about three siblings who fail to find meaning in fame, pleasure and self-improvement schemes.

In each of these films, all the social codes desynchronize, producing a chaotic but creative social environment in which characters strive to find quality experiences, authentic identity and the will to be curious.

You're starting to see a common thread in this whole argument I've been developing around Patchwork. I'm focused on how fracturing leads to a new context that actually gives us beautiful new opportunities. From a breakdown there comes a breakthrough.

The idea of Form—including stable genre–will not dominate the next generation. Instead, artists will stitch together a sense of localized meaning that nevertheless transcends postmodern relativism.

It's not that all combinations can exist because there is no Truth. Rather, faithfully re-combining pieces of exploded tradition will honor the Truth that was once embodied in an overarching narrative.

Some say there is nothing new under the Sun. Yes, perhaps the rubble we combine is a surviving relic of our ancestral Old World.

But the mere possibility of combining rubble in multiple new ways—and the impossibility of using it to just formally resurrect the Past—is something I'm prepared to defend as a nonpareil event.

We saw hints of that nonpareil event in the early 2000s. The event is fully arriving now.

We're being challenged to envision a future. Generational continuity will not simply "happen" automatically for us, like in the traditional past.

While we may long for the security of a Macro Narrative that everyone abides by, we are being offered great freedom. In the absence of an overarching Form, there will be many forms to play with.

I do believe that a similar jubilee moment is coming in the 2020s—but that won't eliminate the attendant chaos and terror that appears in an era "beyond rules."

When you look at fluid social consciousness in such moments as post-9/11 America and what's ahead, it recalls the element of aether, an unconventional "fluid gas" that fills empty space. Aether is something that touches everything and yet is nothing, like some weird hybrid of mind and matter. This aether will concretize at periodic moments: sometimes it will be terrifying, other times aesthetically liberating, and sometimes both at once.

This process will transpire in the business realm as well as in aesthetics. Indeed, you might see business become run more like an artist collective than a profit-vacuuming machine.

When considering the destruction of meta-codes like work and money, it's important not to forget that Time, too, is a meta-code—perhaps the ultimate one upon which all mundane hierarchies depend. Since these codes were detonated in 2020, eliminating the supply chains of meaning we've come to depend on, that may lead to new currencies, payments, financial measurements and ways of doing business.

Ultimately, the coming revaluations in art and business are leading us into a spiritual revolution where multiple timelines can co-exist. Or, we might say, where various groups are free to subscribe to myriad teleological endgames, since no overarching macro narrative is present.

Lacking this overarching context—something that applies to a community across generational and geographic lines—we'll realize we're all individual nodes who have to re-create the vectors that connect us.

In my opinion, 2020 represented a definitive rupture in consciousness, where you can't think of things the in the same cause-and-effect way again. Time is the foundation of art (zeitgeist) and business (financial growth), but when Time explodes, we must find a new way of creating and trading. This is why I say meaning and spiritual resources will be the preeminent commodities of the Patchwork Age. It might be as simple as saying that "quality time" will be the new gold standard.

The three axioms of the Patchwork Age show how this creative chaos is already at work in the world:

1. Desynchronization appears in the absence of a Macro Narrative and leads to fracturing.
2. Fracturing inevitably leads to an asymmetrical state of affairs, where contrarians thrive.
3. Centralized supply chains of meaning are being replaced by decentralized supply chains.

Here is a glossary of the terms used in these axioms:

Desynchronization: A phenomenon which occurs in human communication when a shared context or Macro Narrative disappears, thus eliminating the original synchronization of meaning across time and geography.

For example, say a person at your office wears a mask that's emblazoned with the word "Vote!" It appears they're advertising a wish to build a democratic endgame with you. But if that really was your collective context, the message would be superfluous. It really means: "Vote…for my team." Thus, each person's consciousness is desynchronized because the supportive context underneath (like collective good will) is absent—hence a sublimated conscious presentation of a loss or absence registered in the unconscious.

24/7 information synchronization previously occurred through the coordinated matrix of mainstream media, government and Big Tech.

Fracturing: This is an action that takes the place of collective narrative building, when a shared context has been desynchronized.

Fracturing can even occur *within* cliques or an individual psyche. An example of fracturing within an individual psyche would be rephrasing someone's words in your own specialized language, in reply to their expression. I could offer the credo "Less talk, more action" and someone might reply "Sounds like Bronze Age Mindset."

Rather than letting the person's words exist on their own, or within inter-dependent contexts, there's an attempt to fracture all that out of the picture, so that some totalized worldview can circumscribe itself and retain a semblance of authoritative order, untainted by parallel contexts.

It is a contrarian move where someone defines themselves against a proposition by drawing up an entirely different endgame, allowing them to stand completely outside that proposition's context.

Fracturing within cliques can occur when, for example, a primitive-focused lifestyle (again, say, derivatives of Bronze Age Mindset) nonetheless relies on advanced pharmaceuticals to achieve the primitive physique at the base of its ideological framework. Some will recognize that tech has creeped into their lifestyle aesthetic and try to deflate its antagonism with irony or black humor. Others will stop labeling themselves and their habits altogether, seeing their life as a patchwork of influences.

Likewise, you could see fracturing among New Enlightenment acolytes (who orbit around Peterson, Taleb, *et alia*) when it comes to esoteric concepts. Some within the clique will

peacefully hybridize their contrasting views, patchwork-style; others will cast out heretics for entertaining "woo-woo" ideas.

Exile is a preeminent feature of the Patchwork Age, as is nomadism or nomadic searches for meaning.

Fracturing *between* opposed groups is so ever-present today that the reader can likely call them to mind readily: the Left versus the Right in American politics would be one example. But that is really a product of the old cultural dialectic, and now within these political poles there is splintering, which leads us to the next concept: asymmetry.

Asymmetry: A state of affairs that occurs when fracturing inevitably leads to a multi-polar world consisting of various endgames.

It represents a creative flux where one node's power may grow to a disproportionate degree with respect to parallel nodes (which may be online or in-person communities)—only to have a newly-emergent endgame suddenly devalue that rising node's particular strength.

These new endgames would appear due to shifting conditions—say, regional outbreaks of harsh weather, disease, famine, violence, spiritual apathy or currency destabilization.

Or, a nascent asset would appear, attracting more (relative) power because it could sustain an entirely new endgame. For example, a regional herb could be found to allay some contemporary widespread malady, thus quickly turning a backwater area into an up-and-coming hotspot; people may desire to build families around the area because it allows them to pursue an artistic or entrepreneurial vision cheaply while forging new friendship bonds.

And those bonds hint at a more important issue: "Causes" and "vision" will be the preeminent commodities in the Patchwork Age. They will form the basis of new **supply chains of meaning (see definition below).**

This flux of both power and valuation causes people to constantly spill from clique to clique—or from one totalizing psychological worldview to another—as they nomadically seek the best endgame for their present condition.

For example, prior to Patchwork, a basic K-12 public education would've been considered the gold standard for any given community, because it assured reinvestment in that community after all their kids went off nice universities, graduated and came back to grow families.

Now a "quality public education" means "a quality public education…for my child, built around his/her strengths."

There is desynchronization among families, even when they all say "I just want a good public education for our kids"—because there is no supportive context that ensures continuous growth and similarity of experience within even a local community (due to things like staggered attendance days, virtual schooling, disagreement over the value of standardized testing and syllabi, disagreement over the handling of learning disabilities like Asperger's, municipal funding problems, etc.)

Thus, behind the statement "education must be our number one public priority" is the ghostly absence of a Macro Narrative.

The projected linear growth of home-college-return is an old endgame. As a result, there will be fracturing among cliques and families. Some may be die-hard neo-homeschoolers; others may value the socializing that comes from even staggered attendance days. This produces asymmetry among those that would be ostensible allies. When conditions change rapidly, sometimes new jobs or contexts favor those homeschooled kids—then just as quickly something occurs to reverse that favoritism and boost the stock of traditionally-schooled kids.

The value of certain tribal endgames will not only be affected by large macro factors like economic collapse or resource scarcity, but also pronouncements by competing authority figures: "Online socializing is just as effective as in-person," "Home schooling leads to better sleep cycles for developing teen brains," etc.

But in the Patchwork Age, authority figures will always be at the mercy of the network, not vice-versa. As their pronouncements travel through various networks, the value is shaped as much by network reaction as it is by any inherent rhetorical value.

For example, you may despise homeschooling. If your declared political enemies begin touting a pro-homeschooling authority figure, you may cozy back up to a former ally who briefly pissed you off by embracing processed foods—a deep offense to another of your core values—when that former ally comes around denouncing this supposed pro-homeschooling authority figure.

In the Patchwork Age, an enemy made today can just as quickly become an ally again tomorrow.

In essence, there will be asymmetrical outcomes and practices, society wide. This will gradually push desynchronization up from subconscious awareness into conscious awareness. We will become keenly aware that tribal endgames represent a bottom line for most people.

Calls for unity will result from this painful awareness of a missing Macro Narrative. Asymmetry will hit all sectors, markets and meta-codes behind society:

9-to-5 jobs versus work from home; 24/7 shopping hours versus hours reserved for at-risk seniors in a new pandemic-laden era; inclusive businesses or clubs versus members-only clubs or speakeasies; analog versus digital in artistic production; brick and mortar retail versus digital storefronts; local food consumption versus produce trucked cross-country versus mass-produced "food-like" items; an American republic versus social democracy; rural versus suburban versus exurban versus urban proper.

You could even experience asymmetry across states or regions, as one type of practice is exclusively enforced within a certain radius while its polar opposite is enforced soon as you cross a border.

Again, hybridization—even at the level of, for example, 90 percent digital lifestyle, 10 percent analog—is the peaceful way to deal with this asymmetry and continually-shifting state of affairs. Ideological, tribal rigidity is the pitfall. Hard boundary lines can still maintain peacefulness, but only if some kind of cross-regional, intra-social visa is coordinated and recognized.

These visas may only be distributed to highly successful individuals, however—with success being defined as a vision that organizes one's own local tribe and is seen as a commodity valued by another tribe. You may see a resurgence of a pilgrim-trader class who spreads the word of their tribe's cause and who invites others to subscribe to a delivery from their supply chain of meaning.

Delivery could take the form of a substance/sacrament, or the arrival of a diplomatic group who performs a certain ritual or transmits a certain teaching.

Indeed, many straight-laced business consultancies already operate around this socio-spiritual tribal model. They build trust with certain companies through scouting missions, then host workshops where the company's staff goes through personality tests and experimental modules on new leadership paradigms.

None of this is hard science, nor does it have any financial guarantee, although it may have some empirical backing to support the "vibe." It's predominantly an energy transmission, born from the belief that the consultancy's supply chain of meaning can aid their partner company's endgame.

"Yes, but what does *that* company go on to produce? More vision? Who's going to ultimately foot the bill?"

In times of spiritual crisis, you will not only see whole new commodities but whole new currencies, too. Markets will have to register the collective's desperate need for meaning.

A cute little teapot made in China and delivered next day via Amazon just isn't going to fill the void anymore—especially when it breaks after a handful of uses. Which brings us to the final term in this glossary.

Supply Chain(s) of Meaning:

In the traditional or ancient past, an arcane executive class composed of elders and priests set forth narratives or myths to ensure societal cohesion and individual psychological development within the human family. As man grew more modern, he allowed institutions like Big Government, Big Tech and Big Media to manage supply chains of meaning, i.e. mechanisms for delivering a stable identity and circumscribed worldview. These various supply chains were often bundled together, creating a distinct societal matrix.

As our modern super-society grew, these supply chains began to work against the interests of the individual and the larger society—becoming more dictatorial, totalizing and enfeebling. They were more like delivery avenues for addiction to a certain lifestyle or "truth." They created a state of dependency/complacency, leading to anomie or alienation from the collective and the Higher Self. Meanwhile, these supply chains attenuated the strength of the nuclear family and individual sovereignty—Western society's building block.

Men and women will now manage supply chains of meaning for their local tribe, DIY-style. This will be a distinct shift from parasitical global supply chains. Though we've lost the beneficial supply chains managed by an ancient executive class, we can create new alliances in a desynchronized, asymmetrical society.

Relationships will form around what matters—not a neurochemical lifestyle hit—and around curiosity for another tribe's source of meaning. In that way, various endgames do not necessarily need to be at odds with each other. Instead, it means opportunity for radical trade and for a creative ferment that I call Patchwork Consciousness or the Patchwork Age.

While new material or digital assets may be pumped through these DIY supply chains, the essential transmission will be spiritual in nature. People will be looking for vision, meaning or other forms of transcendent language which can help them and their tribe thrive. Of course, they won't necessarily adopt another tribe's cause whole hog. Instead, they'll take a partial delivery and patch it with their own internal organization. Many business consultancies offer this service already.

Any individual who can travel between separate patches will himself be a stitch that brings the quilt of consciousness together into a state of temporary unity.

The United States of Consciousness, if you will.

Patchwork is what comes after the breakdown of our current society which is very centralized, hierarchical and top down. Centralized institutions all work together, so there's a pipeline that takes you from the institution of higher education to the private sector.

If you are at a bar and you introduce yourself as a student at Stanford University or an analyst at McKinsey, you are tapping into an institution's power to communicate your identity. In a sense, that institution is creating a supply chain of meaning for you. And that institution's identity can be used as a token of meaning that can be traded with other people.

As these institutions disintegrate, the supply chain of meaning associated with them will also breakdown and people aren't going to be able to compare where they stand hierarchically. Society is going to be reorganized horizontally and asymmetrically like a quilt patched together. I've equated Patchwork with the coming Age of Aquarius astrologically, leaving behind the current cycle characterized by rigidity, hierarchy and deception.

We'll have to be Google translators because all human codes are getting disrupted. At present, there are certain cultural markers for decades. You can look back at a movie and say, "Oh, that was made during the 80s." You're not going to be able to do that for this decade or the next. That's why I keep telling people that in Patchwork, you will only know the collective Macro Narrative through its absence. There's just going to be so many competing tribal narratives.

A lot of people won't have any sense of personal chapters at all. They will need to find a way to delineate days, weeks, months, in ways that make sense to them—the way our agricultural ancestors had the different seasons to give them a sense of the passing of time. Self-sufficiency will also include generating meaning for yourself.

I will now seek to describe Patchwork Consciousness in more detail and the ways in which these axioms are operative now in the world.

The Patchwork Manifesto

You walk around now, waiting for life to "return to normal."

You wonder when the old supply chains will be fixed, and when some new narrative will gel for all of us.

The proof is staring you right in the face: all the instances of scattered life—like people desperately posting to local subreddits asking to make friends in a post-pandemic world—point to permanently demolished supply chains of meaning.

What you perceive as a slow trickle ("man, can't wait until X picks up again") actually *is* the new normal you seek to comprehend or see manifested.

These are not delayed deliveries from intact supply chains but rather the enduring bits of rubble from those very chains, which have been permanently demolished.

Social consciousness is in a tailspin now because it doesn't realize that Content is now also Form: such is the proposition of Patchwork or the hybrid energy of Aquarius.

There is no longer a dualism in which Content (human consciousness/emotions/attention etc.) is managed by an external top-down Form (anything from public schools to dating apps to local bars…everything that manages how a consensus society "should" proceed).

A point of order: typically Form or Ground is necessary for Content to appear (Content is also known as Figure in art-speak). The words you see on this page appear to be Content supported by the Form of a blank page. Without the abstraction of this constraining form, you wouldn't be able to read Content and see me develop a linear argument.

But Patchwork is intermixing of all that, pushing the limits of our perception and consciousness. While this is a book and retains elements of linearity, you've probably also noticed that I've subscribed to a stream of consciousness style, too.

At any rate, back to the civilizational focus. Delivery mechanisms like dating apps or local bars no longer exist in a context of a consensus society, where people go through linear progressive stages of intimacy and trust, enshrined by established codes.

We will all have to accept a scarcity that is paradoxically not scarcity due to the fact that *rules* have also been detonated along with the structures themselves.

"The People" have been freed: now they are autonomous and liberated from the constraints of Form.

They are free to combine through infinitely new modes of expression, timeframes & trajectories—if they can see this fearful new landscape as one of opportunity.

Previously, the human family—the backdrop against which the individual develops—was supported by a cohesive integrated society and set of reliable meta-stories, as put forth by a trustworthy executive class (typically a small circle of male elders). This was the Form under which the Content of individuality developed.

But as I've been arguing here, world-historical transits events allowed corruption to seep into that executive class, and so society destabilized.

In this post-hierarchical Patchwork Age, human beings and their energy/attention (i.e. Content) are now also simultaneously the dominant Form.

Again, dating apps, the K-12 school system, 9-5 jobs, afterwork bars, etc., all these "normal" social codes are no longer surrogates of some dominant Form: they are ruins we must patch together in new ways so that human relationships can cohere. These zones will no longer operate in the same old way where all you have to do is show up and tap their supply chain of meaning.

This is a post-rapacious model that's good for all of us. No more harvesting of human energy for greed.

What you see before you—in all its asymmetric chaos—*is* the Macro Narrative. Or, at least, the remnants of a once-dominant Macro Narrative.

This decoupling of human consciousness (Content) from heretofore Immutable Forms (like "polite society") is what gives that Content such a degree of autonomy that it also becomes its own self-determined Form.

Human consciousness has been freed from the system that sought to parasitize it. That consciousness is now at liberty to be a producer who also benefits directly from what they produce.

You can see how a socialist might try to use this as proof of an oncoming socialist age. But they'd be sorely mistaken. Socialist threads will emerge only because a Patchwork society accepts all factions in order to multiply network ripple effects. Patchwork just likes to see what happens when you put a socialist neighbor next to a conservative neighbor, because the primary interest is in hybrid meaning creation. Thus, we are trending more towards ultra-capitalism or DIY "ethical" capitalism.

There is no "ground" to the activity you see before you now, no auto-consensus, no public square or intact Macro Narrative.

What you have is a radical new decentralized consciousness that cannot be "put back into" a Form—and will resist with all its might if someone tries to do that, whether they be a socialist or a flashback Traditionalist.

Try going about business as usual in certain settings, from love to work: see how they (and you) instinctively resist the artificially-imposed constraints.

Still feeling adrift in this new land, dear reader? You are trying to "interpret" reality, trying to find the deeper scaffolding that supports it—but that is the Old Model, and there is no underlying guaranteed structure.

You try to circumscribe some external narrative, some proscenium arch, some Surround or Form—and it doesn't work because the field of activity transpiring before you exists as *one flow* in which Content and Form intermix as a wavelength.

So, in a Patchwork environment, you can't fully and truly detach yourself from this energetic field as an observer. This would be a sly way to reinstate the Old Model in which some external circumscription or Form can contain the Content of human consciousness. More and more people will see how this circumscription serves the will of egoic pursuits like domination, extraction, greed, exclusive status, etc.

When the field of activity you exist in is a flow or wavelength that doesn't allow you to become a dominant detached observer, that means multiple contexts or timelines or poles of power are existing and interacting simultaneously, creating unpredictable ripple effects, which continually change the relations between all individuals, *ad infinitum*.

Thus, power is not stable in a Patchwork world—it does not stay in one place for any long period of time. Like electricity, it is leaping almost randomly from point to point as the number of interactions increase, facilitated by the fall of old Formal boundaries. Factions are perma-fluid as people constantly unstitch themselves and stitch together new value propositions.

So as you sit here trying to determine exactly where and when the Old Order fell, it's already too late for such analyses: your consciousness already exists in a new paradigm in which that mere activity of observation introduces new variables.

In other words, you are still trying to think in terms of linear time, when you now live in a post-linear, post-causal world.

Oftentimes in Patchwork environments, the stimuli that prompts your question is always already the answer you seek.

That's why I say you will know the Macro Narrative through its absence.

You ask existential questions—"When will things return to normal or gel into a New Normal?"—you wonder such things precisely because you *already exist* in an asymmetric state of affairs that's here to stay.

In other words, you ask "Where's the Macro Narrative?" precisely at the point when you can never get it back, when the environment has shifted into a micro narrative paradigm, when you feel "something's off."

Fact is, the impetus to ask arises from a set of circumstances that prevents the return of a Macro Narrative. Circumstances which we've never really lived through before. Circumstances that might be described as breaking the Chains of Consciousness. Circumstances that contain within them the ghost of the Old Order and the promise of a Brave New World.

What you try to isolate before you as a particle is really a Free Wave/Flow inseparable from your perceiving consciousness.

You cannot "logic your way" back to the Old Order from its remnants, precisely because the freeing of those remnants introduces a profoundly New Order.

Here, human consciousness is free to exist as a wave/flow, as Form and Content in one, not dependent on an external dominating source to provide Form. No more of: "This is how to think normally, love normally, fuck normally, make money normally…"

Normal normal normal…where everyone is herded into the paddocks of consensus from which only a few at the very tip top actually benefit.

You see, many of those old remnants are still valuable because they are charged with the consciousness of your ancestors, albeit a consciousness that was intertwined with codes and myths. A corrupt elite took this intertwined feature of our ancestral past and ran with it: in the consumerist Society of Babel, *you* became the programmable product rather than an active participant in building your legacy.

Buddy, I hate to break it to you, but: *you* were the one consumed by glossy marketed messages of freedom. You did not receive more generational legacy through your participation. Rather, your time was harvested.

It's not your fault. Our ancestors had great intentions, and this way of organizing the human collective goes back *ages*…too far, perhaps, for any spiritual genealogist. The purpose of myth is *that* old. As old as old can get. The dawn of agrarian civilization or even earlier. Very, very primitive.

Of course, the surviving globalists will do everything they can to associate themselves and their totalizing vision with those enduring bits of rubble. "Oh, you admit that some type of governance is essential going forward? Well, step right up, we've got the UN, the CDC, the…"

It is, however, too late for the hyper-elite to regain top-down control of society. The genie, as the saying goes, cannot be put back in the bottle.

In esoteric terms, the asymmetric presence of resources proves that you live in a post-consensus society.

"Oh, government will always be this way, we will never have decentralized regional federations or blockchain voting."

"Oh, dating will always be this way, people aren't just going to take themselves off the market completely or create neo-harems or this thing or that…or…"

Really now!

We are beginning to exist in a post-casual world. All social codes are disintegrating, producing unpredictable ripple effects. There is both confusion and creativity in the air.

It is therefore up to you to create your own supply chains of meaning.

We will also "discover" new resources. A sense of infinity is at hand.

But don't be surprised if people cling to those dead structures—even people you respect.

We've blown up the Tower of Babel, but all people can think of is how inconvenienced they are—not realizing how they've been freed and how reconstructing Babel would lead to an even worse fate than before.

Some people might not even realize that Babel has been blown up. They just think it's temporarily closed and they gnash their teeth, waiting for the "chaos" (opportunity) to end, so they can "go back to normal" or even a "new normal"

How's that steak, Cypher?

Why not embrace the change—experience a breakthrough via breakdown?

We will see breakdown through the utter desynchronization of meta-codes. OK, you've got a kid in high school: what do you do?

Private school, public school but virtual, a district with in-person public school…maybe just let the kid choose? It's all up in the air, and each of his friends are choosing different avenues. There's no consensus.

Likewise, as physical goods experience disruptions or the next pandemic flares up, we may see staggered delivery windows or special shopping hours for at-risk seniors or secret clubs with access to limited edition goods.

Violent tribalism will surge among the un-self-aware. Symbols and semiotics will usurp so much emotional and cognitive bandwidth that they'll reach a degree of autonomy not suited for non-sentient Forms. This is how people will desperately try to reinstate the Old Order—tribal violence over a red MAGA hat or a BLM sign.

But there will be all sorts of positive decentralized movements resulting from this desynchronization, too. Fiction writers, for example, will rise on the ashes of an over-scaffolded publishing industry. We will likely see the return of artistic pieces that resonate across multiple generations, instead of the recent trend to silo everyone into chambers of self-curated delight.

Just as there will be a jagged Patchwork map in physical spaces, the inner psyche of individuals will fragment *ad infinitum*, until the individual is so fractionated he can no longer fit in boxes like "Conservative" or "Liberal." This will dismantle Cancel Culture as everyone sees the multiplicities within themselves.

But fractionation may also cause reticence and anxiety, as this can have an erosive or even pulverizing effect on the individual ego. This monastic anxiety will lead people to hunger for a Macro Narrative even more—although, ironically, such narratives will exist in ghostly form as a direct result of such hyper-individualization.

Ultimately, Patchwork is a socio-spiritual process driven by greater sensitivity to electromagnetic frequencies and desire for unity. People will really want to know if you "feel them" or if "you're on my wavelength"—though, true, some may go completely solo like a modern desert mystic, as some supreme avatar of Patchwork Consciousness.

Unity and consensus is never achieved in the Patchwork Age. We are always working towards Tomorrow. Or, if unity is achieved, it's temporary. The unusual alliances that come together over a shared interest in a particular idealistic endgame will abruptly disband (often amicably)

when some kind of threshold is reached. Then each individual splinters off and finds new networks to interface with, new causes to champion, new timelines to experience.

The abrupt, shocking energy of the Patchwork Age is not to be downplayed. Relationships and events may suddenly spiral out of control and break for no logical reason. In the air, there's a sense of being at the mercy of larger electromagnetic pulses that push you into new territory, tastes and values—surprising even yourself.

Thus, there will be a general nomadism reflective of the psycho-spiritual nomadism occurring. All forms of shelter and land will be completely shaken-up in the Patchwork Age and sometimes inverted overnight.

Rents and mortgages will have to grapple with the value fluctuations as society bifurcates between chronic nomads and newfound homesteaders. A communal living trend will spread, not only placing old public territory into question—such as the CHAZ enclaves in Seattle—but also generating a social trend of cults or harems with charismatic leaders.

"Benevolent dictators" will pop up for those who desperately seek security in meta-codes. In a word, they will establish autonomous zones with the *semblance* of meta-codes, as long as you stay within the fantasy or the zone's physical limits.

Basically, there will be sociopaths who take advantage of the fact that no overarching context exists for human interactions. Due to the Patchwork axiom of asymmetry, they won't be able to accrue enough power to be a dominant force, but they may be a persistent nuisance.

And, really, the problem with harems or cults that get greedy in terms of increased reach is that, as I mentioned, they try to stand apart from the giant flux that society becomes in the Patchwork Age.

When they try to do that, they'll realize they actually have no control over the course of things. Everyone is subject to the sporadic, decentralized nature of the New Order. This is actually a great general trend for tamping down on that tribal violence or territorial spats, because quickly no one will know who is fighting who, or for what—the territory fought over may even evaporate as soon as things get to the point of heating up.

More than anything, Patchwork Consciousness wants to maximize connective potential and ripple effects in the collective network, so every spat in essence ironically serves the purpose of combinatory growth. In Patchwork, every node is also a vector, which is why it's futile to think of yourself as a unit who can simply be grouped in tribes based on external signifiers like political affiliation.

In the same fashion, there won't necessarily be a new "hive" of artists working to push the limits or reinvigorate a particular medium, for example.

Instead, there'll be a wavelength or frequency that appears to connect them, almost unconsciously—an organic trend that flows above all the micro-narratives they are each propagating. They will be united in their disavowal of stale models and top-down censorship. Call it an artistic revolution or renaissance.

Ultimately, good-heartedness will reign because none of us will be able to escape the penetrating eye of introspection. Concurrent with the social and creative fermentation will be battles against solitude and alienation, born from the fact that we all fully own our consciousness now and see it perhaps for the first time in the glaring light of day.

People will see warring camps within themselves, *ad infinitum*, layer by layer—and what they will want, more than anything, is the relief of spontaneous unity. Many will give up on trying to control chaos with impositions of Form.

What we're seeing now is an unraveling of a great scheme. No more borrowing against the future, no more expectation that people will slave away for identities and commodities that give them a sense of (relative) power and (false) meaning.

2020 may have separated the Winners from the Losers—those who fought to preserve on-demand sources of meaning and those who went independent. But it's true that we no longer live in an Us versus Them world anymore, either. That's far too centralized a thing, and so the "losers" have a role to play in the Patchwork world.

As long as both the "losers" and the "winners" remain open or agreeable, the possibility of trade remains. Of course, as we've been saying, the preeminent commodity in the Patchwork Age will be meaning or vision.

Losers thus have a very crucial role to play in this New World where "we're all in this together" but also where unity remains perpetually elusive. They are undergoing a healing process because their old supply chain of meaning has been cut off. They have a unique perspective. Many of these foot soldiers weren't and aren't inherently bad people: they were simply misled by intellectual thugs, and their natural compassion was taken advantage of.

The nature of Patchwork is that one person or one perspective always stands apart from any proposed endgame. Their contrarianism, right or wrong, serves the vital function of always maintaining unity as a horizon at the very same time that they prevent unity.

Having this perpetually-elusive unity as a macro horizon will totally change collective consciousness. In previous decades, our macro horizon was very carceral, very Us versus Them—like a big, nasty prison brawl.

On the cusp of the Patchwork Age, a winner is declared and the prison walls come down. Winners set the future tone, but rules take the backseat as we become a more open and experimental people.

It's not like the winners simply decree how things will be, forever and ever amen. That's just more Us versus Them hierarchy. What winners do in a post-centralized society is make proposals, and these proposals invite contrarianism from allies or, you guessed it, even from losers.

In general, contrarianism leads to more freedom and creativity because it generates radical solutions. Graceful losers have a role to play in a society of multiplicities. There's a proactive pole with winning proposals and an oppositional pole with respectful contrarianism. It's a feedback loop of constitutional liberty.

Upon winning the Revolutionary War, the Founding Fathers did not reinstate a centralized monarchy. They created a system of checks and balances by which one election's losers could become tomorrow's winners. This is the beauty of a society built on reason and an open marketplace of ideas.

The keywords here are graceful and respectful. Winners can make losers graceful by remaining open to the possibility of trade.

Of course, the winners will remember the resentful intelligentsia and the so-called experts who threatened them with exile over the years. We might very well see the media class, for example, soon go from sparkly darlings to mangy stray dogs. They are not contrarians; they are a nuisance.

Some of you are already exploring this New World. However, many are still coming to terms with the fall of the Us versus Them wall—that relic of the Old World.

The Patchwork Age will come together in fits and starts, stitch by stitch.